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PR XP Z12-014

**B2B use cases applicable within the framework of the Electronic
Invoicing Reform in France**

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Foreword

This document is intended for all organizations that wish to exchange electronic invoices in the context of French regulations (Electronic Invoice Reform as described in Articles 289, 289BIS, 290 and 290A of the General Tax Code), but also more broadly in compliance with the provisions of Directive 2006-112-EC, amended by EU Directive 2025/516 known as ViDA (VAT in the Digital Age).

This document deals with use cases applicable to the Electronic Invoice Reform in France, as identified in the preparatory work carried out by the team in charge at the DGFIP (French Public Finance Administration) and continued within the AFNOR Electronic Invoice Standardization Commission.

The purpose of this document is to support stakeholders in the ecosystem, starting with Accredited Platforms ("Plateformes Agréées"), but also OD/SC ("Solution Compatibles"), management solution publishers, and companies and their advisors in implementing the reform. This consists first of all in indicating how the information contained in invoices can be incorporated into the semantic model and implementation profiles described in Standard XP Z12-012. It also involves indicating how life cycle statuses can be used, created and, in certain cases, used as a means of transmitting additional documents or even retransmitting invoices and statuses to third parties. Finally, it involves defining recommendations regarding the dynamics of exchanges between the players involved in a commercial transaction, particularly third parties to the SELLER and the BUYER.

The Commission's work was carried out in accordance with the following two principles:

- "Same problems, same solutions." The work and consultation showed that what some companies considered to be their specific characteristics were in fact shared with other companies and, above all, with other situations and sectors that were completely different.
- "Do not export complexity to counterparties": some use cases involve third parties and sometimes require additional data. This can lead to counterparties being required to provide and therefore manage additional information, or even parallel exchanges, which creates complexity for counterparties. In many cases, this can be avoided by considering that it is either the BUYER or the THIRD PARTY acting on its behalf, or the SELLER or the THIRD PARTY acting on its behalf, who is responsible for organizing information sharing or collaborative processing within its own ecosystem.

Knowledge of the EN16931 standards, as well as the UBL, UN/CEFACT CII and UN/CEFACT CDAR implementation syntaxes, and the XP Z12-012 standard documentation is an essential prerequisite for reading this document.

This document first describes the general aspects of invoice exchange and life cycle management, including the impacts in the event of refusal, rejection, etc.

Next, instructions for the various use cases are provided in an appendix, which covers each of the situations or issues reported by the members of the Commission, which have been processed and documented.

This document is intended to evolve, firstly due to the reporting of new use cases, but also due to changes to the XP Z12-012 standard, initially to enhance the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile to enable better resolution of certain use cases, but also due to international work and changes to the EN16931 standard itself.

Preliminary note

As part of the reform, the term "Partner Dematerialization Platform (PDP)" has been replaced by "Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée") (PA)" and the term "Dematerialization Operator (OD)" has been replaced by "Compatible Solution (SC)".

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VERSION MANAGEMENT

Version No.	Version date	Description of changes
V1.0	2025 06 03	Initial version
V1.1	2025 07 31	Following comments and corrections, editorial changes, and additions and/or modifications below: Chapter 4.1.4: More detailed explanation of electronic invoicing addresses and their uses. Chapter 4.1.5: Application of Standard Z12-014, Addition Annex A: see Version Management in Annex A Annex B: examples of invoices and life cycles for the nominal use cases
V1.2	2025 10 31	Update following the name change of PDPs to Accredited Platforms (“Plateformes Agréées”), and the introduction of Compatible Solutions Details on addressing Management of invoices addressed to a taxpayer not equipped with PA-R (chapter 4.2.3 added). Annex A: a few corrections and new use cases, including the management of invoice sub-lines, multi-vendor invoices, “Sociétés en Participation”, grouped payments - netting/offsetting in cross-purchases/sales, bartering, and tax exemption management (see Version Management in Annex A). Annex B: update following corrections and comments.
V1.3	2026 02 26	Addition of the definition of flow 11, supplement to that of flow 10. Chapter 4.1.4.2: some corrections Addition of Chapter 4.1.4.5 on the choice of electronic addresses and the consequences in the event of a change of PA. Annex A: third-party management, international B2B invoices and e-reporting, DROM/COM Annex B: addition of examples of multi-vendor invoices
V1.4	2026 06 30	Chapter 4.2.5: Added details on the use of the “Rejected” status. Appendix A: Port tax (Octroi de mer), cross-sales, and two-way self-billing; several additions, including information on profit margin. Addition of industry-specific chapters: Energy, Media (advertising), Real Estate. See Appendix A for details on the changes. Appendix B: Addition of examples of bidirectional invoices and corrections.

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Introduction

As part of the Electronic Invoicing Reform in France, governed by Articles 289bis, 290, 290 A of the General Tax Code, applicable from September 2026, the AFNOR Electronic Invoicing Commission was set up to describe the invoice formats and profiles and lifecycle statuses that constitute the minimum requirements that Accredited Platforms (“Plateformes Agréées”, PA) shall support, enabling any entity subject to the reform (VAT-registered in France) using these same formats to exchange them with their counterparties in accordance with the requirements of the reform.

However, processing an invoice is not limited to simply sending it; it also involves managing its life cycle, which may result in it being corrected or cancelled by another invoice (a credit note or a corrected invoice). In addition, it is also necessary to support companies in using standard formats, as described in EN16931 and XP Z12-12, to include all information that is present and deemed useful or necessary in invoices. Similarly, certain use cases can impact the traditional lifecycle of an invoice, which, for example, may be paid before it is issued or may be refused even though it has already been paid by direct debit. Finally, a number of use cases involve third parties, such as payers, approvers, invoicing parties, payment recipients, and employees (for expenses), who may play a role in managing the life cycle or even in the circulation of invoices.

All of this has led to the need to document all of these use cases to enable consistent and standardized processing for all parties involved.

This is the purpose of this document, which first describes the general context and the actors potentially involved, then the management of addressing, which is central to the organization of flows and exchanges. This has ultimately led to the conclusion that invoices

- are always issued by the SELLER or on its behalf, using a PA-E that issues on behalf of the SELLER,
- and transmitted to the BUYER or on its behalf to an electronic billing address that it has designated and entrusted to a PA-R, which receives on behalf of the BUYER.

It is therefore also necessary to specify how life cycle messages will then be exchanged in both directions, which also involves a SELLER electronic address where the SELLER wishes to receive life cycle status messages for each of its invoices issued. The only exception to this principle is in the case of self-billing, where the flow is reversed under certain conditions, with invoices being created and issued by the BUYER to the SELLER on behalf of the SELLER under an invoicing mandate.

This document then describes the life cycle of an invoice and how standard invoice processing is organized, first when it is processed normally and paid, but also when it is Rejected, Refused, Partially Approved, or subject to a credit note or corrected invoice request, etc.

Next, in Annex A, all use cases documented at the date of publication of this document are presented and documented.

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1 Scope

This document covers the life cycle of an invoice, from its creation to its payment, as well as how the various stages of exchange and processing shall take place, and then applies these presentations to all use cases implemented in companies, such as self-billing, factoring, management of advance and final invoices, management of employee expenses, management of subcontracting with direct payment, invoices already paid or paid by third parties, invoices from certain sectors such as energy, transport, agriculture, advertising purchases, marketplace purchases, etc.

For each of these use cases, this document and its annexes also aim to describe what falls under the obligation of Accredited Platforms (PA) due to their regulatory obligations and what falls under optional features that more specifically meet the needs of the situation, but also what falls under the obligations of the parties involved in the commercial transaction, starting with the SELLER and the BUYER and sometimes certain third parties and intermediaries.

2 Normative references

The following reference documents are essential for the application of this document. For dated references, only the edition cited applies. For undated references, the latest edition of the reference document applies (including any amendments).

- NF EN 16931-1+A1, Electronic invoicing — Part 1: Semantic data model for the essential elements of an electronic invoice, published in November 2019.
- CEN/TS 16931-2:2017, Electronic invoicing — Part 2: List of syntaxes compliant with EN 16931-1
- CEN/TS 16931-3-1:2017, Electronic invoicing — Part 3-1: Methodology for syntax mapping of the essential elements of an electronic invoice
- CEN/TS 16931-3-2:2017, Electronic invoicing — Part 3-2: Syntax mapping for ISO/IEC 19845 (UBL 2.1) — UBL 2.1 Invoice and Credit Note schema, published in June 2020.
- CEN/TS 16931-3-3:2017, Electronic invoicing — Part 3-3: Syntax mapping for the Cross Industry Invoice syntax — UN/CEFACT D16B XML schema, published in June 2020.
- CEN/TR 16931-4:2017, Electronic invoicing — Part 4: Guidelines for the interoperability of electronic invoices at the transmission level
- CEN/TR 16931-5:2017, Electronic invoicing — Part 5: Guidelines for the use of sectoral or national extensions to EN 16931-1, based on a methodology to be applied in the real environment
- CEN/TR 16931-6, Electronic invoicing — Part 6: Results of tests of EN 16931-1 with regard to its practical application for an end user — Test methodology
- The Factur-X documentation, which is free of copyright and available from FNFE-MPE and FeRD, the French and German national e-invoicing forums, respectively, latest version 1.07.3 published on May 7, 2025, on the website www.fnfe-mpe.org.
- Standard XP Z12-012: Formats and Profiles for Invoice Messages and Life Cycle Statuses, constituting the minimum requirements applicable to the Electronic Invoicing Reform in France
- Standard XP Z12-013: API for interfacing company information systems with Accredited Platforms.

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3 Terms and definitions

For the purposes of this document, the terms and definitions given in this document and the following terms and definitions apply.

3.1

PPF Directory (“Annuaire”)

directory of parties subject to the Electronic Invoicing Reform and recipients of electronic invoices within the scope defined by the latter. The directory of recipients is implemented by the PPF for the purposes of the reform

3.2

CIUS

"Core Invoice Usage Specification": Specification for the use of electronic invoice messages

3.3

Data Concentrator (or CdD PPF)

PPF service responsible for concentrating e-invoicing data (domestic B2B and B2G invoices and the life cycle of these invoices) and e-reporting (invoice, transaction, and payment data excluding e-invoicing) for the tax authorities

3.4

"e-invoicing"

refers to the scope of the Electronic Invoicing Reform relating to the exchange of electronic invoices between VAT-registered entities in France, for the exchange of Flow 1, Flow 2 and Flow 6, and the transmission of data required by the reform to the Administration via Flow 1

3.5

EN 16931

European semantic standard for essential data in an electronic invoice

3.6

"e-reporting"

refers to the scope of the Electronic Invoicing Reform relating to sales, acquisitions and transactions that do not fall within the scope of "e-invoicing" and are listed in Articles 290 and 290A of the General Tax Code (international B2B sales, international B2B acquisitions, B2C sales, payment for sales for which VAT is payable upon receipt). This section gives rise to the transmission of a Flow 10 and a Flow 6 for the payment receipt status of invoices for which VAT is payable upon receipt

3.7

EXTENSION

extension of the EN 16931 profile due to the addition of data or data groups, an increase in the cardinality of certain data or data groups in the EN 16931 model, or the addition of new code values applicable to certain fields

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3.8

Flow 1, Flow 2, Flow 3, Flow 6, Flow 8, Flow 9, Flow 10

flows refer to the different types of messages exchanged as part of the reform:

- Flow 1: corresponds to the Invoice message, transmitted by the PA-E issuing the invoices to the PPF Data Concentrator (CdD PPF), containing only the data required by the Tax Administration for invoices falling within the scope of "e-invoicing" (electronic invoices between VAT-registered entities)
- Flow 2: corresponds to the invoice message exchanged between entities subject to the reform and to be transmitted via Accredited Platform (PA), in accordance with the provisions of this document.
- Flow 3: corresponds to the invoice message exchanged between entities subject to the reform and to be transmitted via Accredited Platform (PA), BUT which is in a third-party format agreed between the issuer and the recipient and contains all the information required by the tax authorities in a structured form and allows for the compliant extraction of data for the creation of Flow 1 or Flow 10.
- Flow 6: corresponds to the life cycle status message relating to electronic invoice exchanges, implemented in UN/CEFACT CII.
- Flow 8: corresponds to the invoice message exchanged between an entity subject to the reform and an international entity complying with the provisions of this document.
- Flow 9: corresponds to the invoice message exchanged between an entity subject to the reform and a non-taxable entity established in France (mainly an individual), in accordance with the provisions of this document.
- Flow 10: corresponds to the "e-reporting" message that entities subject to the Electronic Invoice Reform shall transmit to the Data Concentrator via their «Plateformes Agréées» (PA). A completed version of flow 10 is described, allowing companies subject to the reform to transmit e-reporting data to their "Plateforme Agréée" in several stages, with the latter responsible for compiling (optional service) the final flow 10 to be transmitted to the Data Concentrator.
- Flow 11: corresponds to the message enabling Accredited Platforms ("Plateformes Agréées") to transmit publishable data from the PPF "Annuaire" to end-users.

All of these flows can be implemented in the various use cases documented in this document and its annexes

3.9

Minimum base formats and profiles

the base formats and profiles are the structured or mixed data formats that shall be supported within the framework of the Electronic Invoice Reform, which implements the EN 16931 standard.

On the one hand, three formats make up this base for the Invoice message, each implementing two data profiles:

- Profile EN 16931, which is a CIUS for France implementing Standard EN 16931
- EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile, which is an EXTENSION for France implementing the EN 16931 standard

These two profiles are implemented in two syntaxes (UBL and UN/CEFACT CII) and in the mixed Factur-X format, more specifically:

- XML ISO/IEC 19845 syntax (UBL 2.1): the UBL (Universal Business Language) format complies with the OASIS U.B.L. 2.1 standard.
- UN/CEFACT CII syntax. The CII (Cross Industry Invoice) format complies with the UN/CEFACT SCRDM CII (Supply Chain Reference Data Model – Cross Industry Invoice) standard. The language version selected for the reform is UN/CEFACT CII D22B.
- Factur-X. Factur-X is a hybrid (or mixed) electronic invoice format combining a PDF file compliant with ISO-19005-3 PDF/A-3, which constitutes the READABLE representation of the invoice, with a structured

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representation of the data in factur-x.xml in UN/CEFACT CII syntax attached to it. Facture-X has additional profiles (MINIMUM, BASIC WL, BASIC, and EXTENDED).

In addition, the life cycle status format is implemented in the UN/CEFACT CDAR (Cross Domain Acknowledgement and Response) syntax and is also part of the minimum base formats and profiles

3.10

Electronic Invoice Reform

electronic invoicing reform applicable in France from September 1, 2026, as described in Articles 289, 289bis, 290, and 290A of the General Tax Code

3.11

Accredited Platform (“Plateforme Agréé” - PA)

Partner Dematerialization Platform: Electronic invoicing platform through which electronic invoices between VAT-registered entities falling within the scope of the Electronic Invoicing Reform's "e-invoicing" shall be exchanged, along with "e-reporting" data for international B2B invoices excluding imports of goods, B2C transactions, and payments.

In this document and its annexes, AP-E refers to the Accredited Platform (PA) responsible for issuing the invoice, and AP-R refers to the Accredited Platform (PA) responsible for receiving the invoice

3.12

PPF

Public Invoicing Portal, an administrative platform offering recipient directory and data concentrator services

3.13

Compatible Solution or SC

Compatible Solutions are management solutions used by companies upstream or downstream of invoice exchange that claim to be compatible with the requirements of the electronic invoice reform in France, namely their ability to create, integrate, and check the compliance of electronic invoices in one of the minimum base formats described in this Standard, as well as in the creation, checking, and processing of life cycle status messages as described in this Standard.

This corresponds to the concept of a Dematerialization Operator (OD), initially described in the external specifications of the PPF, with a notion of compatibility with the regulatory and normative requirements in which they partially participate. Compatible Solutions are connected to one or more Accredited Platforms (PA) to issue or receive electronic invoices and life cycle status messages

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4 B2B use cases applicable in the context of the Electronic Invoicing reform in France

4.1 General

4.1.1 Presentation of the invoicing process and the parties involved

Following the decision to refocus the functions of the PPF (Public Invoicing Portal) on managing the Directory and the Data Concentrator, B2B invoice exchanges between taxable entities are now carried out exclusively through Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»). This corresponds to Circuit C as described in the document on use cases for external specifications, version 2.4.

As a reminder, B2G exchanges are carried out via the CHORUSPRO Platform, which will remain the platform for public entities subject to invoice receipt obligations in the public sector. However, private sector invoice issuers will also be able to use their Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») to issue invoices to the public sector. In addition, certain complex use cases involve exchanges between private actors associated with a public actor (co-contracting, subcontracting). This document will therefore also describe these use cases.

This document is intended to provide guidance on various use cases that correspond to business practices, generally on a sector-by sector basis. The objective is to propose best practices for implementation, whether in terms of how to implement invoicing data in the minimum base formats, which are the subject of a separate publication, how to use life cycle statuses in the dynamics of exchanges and processing, but also to define a minimum functional base that Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») are required to implement.

This document therefore distinguishes between the obligations of Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») and the optional best practice features for ecosystem players, namely Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»), management solution publishers involved in invoice management, taxable entities, third parties, and more generally everything included in the term OD (Dematerialization Operator)/SC (Compatible Solution).

This document is based on the use of the minimum base formats and profiles as described in standard XP Z12-012, in addition to the external specifications that describe the specifications of the interfaces between the PPF (Directory and Data Concentrator) and the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»), including the description of flows 1, 10, as well as the use of flow 6 of the Life Cycle applied only to exchanges between Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») and the PPF.

As a reminder, standard XP Z12-012 describes the use of semantic standard EN16931 in the context of the reform through two main profiles (EN16931 and EXTENDED-CTC-FR) and a temporary profile implemented in the Factur-x hybrid format (BASIC WL). Additional management rules have been defined to comply with the requirements of the reform, as well as rules for extracting and transforming structured invoice data to constitute the data required by the tax authorities (flow 1 and flow 10.1). These profiles are then implemented in three formats, namely:

- UBL 2.1.
- UN/CEFACT CII D22B.
- Factur-X, which is an hybrid format consisting of a PDF/A-3 representation (ISO 19005-3), to which a file containing the essential invoice data in UN/CEFACT CII D22B format is attached.

Finally, the standard also describes how the CDAR (Cross Domain Acknowledgment and Response) life cycle status message should be used by end users (entities subject to VAT in France) and their Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»), as well as between Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») themselves.

The use cases covered in this document describe how invoice data fits into the XP Z12-012 standard data model, whose life cycle statuses are exchanged, whether in the invoice transmission or processing phase, as well as the dynamics of exchanges between the various parties involved (SELLER, BUYERS, their Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») and information systems, including OD/SC (Compatible Solution), as well

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as various third parties and their Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») /OD/SC (Compatible Solution)).

These use cases can be divided into three main categories, bearing in mind that some fall into several categories:

- Use cases requiring instructions for implementing invoice data, where applicable requiring additional data, and/or a relaxation of certain management rules, i.e., the use of the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile.
- Use cases involving third parties, which means addressing the issues of invoice sharing and life cycle with these third parties.
- Use cases impacting the life cycle, generally due to the involvement of third parties, but also primarily the management of rejections, refusals, disputes, etc., and anything that requires multiple invoices, corrected invoices, or credit notes to process the invoicing of the underlying transaction.

In these different use cases, several parties are likely to be involved (in capital letters in the text):

- The SELLER is the party that provides the goods or services covered by an invoice. The seller records the invoice in their accounts (as revenue or advance payments). When the invoice includes VAT, the SELLER is responsible for collecting it and therefore declaring it as VAT collected (unless they use a TAX REPRESENTATIVE of the SELLER). The SELLER is also often referred to as the Supplier.
- The BUYER is the person who purchased the product or service. They are therefore always the ones who record the invoice in their accounts as the buyer (as an expense, inventory, fixed asset, or advance payment). When the invoice includes VAT, it is the BUYER who can deduct it, and it is therefore the BUYER who declares the deductible VAT. In most cases, it is the BUYER who pays the invoice. The BUYER may also be referred to as the Customer.
- THE SELLER'S TAX REPRESENTATIVE, who represents the SELLER vis-à-vis the tax authorities if the SELLER does not represent themselves, primarily in relation to VAT returns.
- THE PAYEE, who is the recipient of the invoice payment when it is not the SELLER. An invoice may have several PAYEES (only in the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile). For example, a factoring company is a PAYEE.
- Other Parties have been deemed useful for addressing certain use cases. They are not present in the EN16931 semantic model for essential invoice data, but have been added to the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile, which is part of the Minimum Base that taxable entities and Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») MUST be able to process:
 - ✓ The INVOICER is a third party who creates and issues the invoice on behalf of the SELLER. They must do so under the SELLER's invoicing mandate, in accordance with the regulations in force (see BOI-TVA-DECLA-30-20-10, articles 340 to 500).
 - ✓ The SELLER'S AGENT, who acts on behalf of the SELLER, for example when they are in charge of sales and sometimes invoicing (in which case they are also the INVOICER), or even payment receipt.
 - ✓ The ADDRESSEE, more accurately referred to in the standards as the "Billed to," is the Party to whom the invoice is sent because they are responsible for processing it on behalf of the BUYER. However, the use of multiple electronic invoicing addresses for receiving invoices makes it possible to avoid using this ability to send invoices to a third party, but simply to allow that third party to process invoices addressed to the BUYER at an electronic invoicing address (an invoice reception mailbox) whose management is entrusted to that third party by the BUYER. However, when the ADDRESSEE is named on the invoice, this allows the PA-R (receiving party) to manage delegation rights in a more targeted manner to allow it to access the invoice and the processing actions for which it has been delegated. This third party may also enable compliance with the requirements of Article 441-9 of the French Commercial Code, which requires that the postal address of the entity that receives and processes the invoice on behalf of the BUYER be provided (invoicing address if different from the customer's (BUYER's) address, which should be interpreted as the postal invoicing address).
 - ✓ The BUYER'S AGENT, who acts on behalf of the BUYER, often because they were in charge of the ordering phase and can therefore set the processing status (approval, dispute, etc.).

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- ✓ The PAYER, who is the payer of the invoice when it is not the BUYER. For example, when a company within a group is responsible for payments for all of the group's subsidiaries, or in the case of a subcontracting invoice with direct payment from the end customer. There may also be several PAYERS (for example, an invoice that is paid in part by an insurer and in part by the BUYER).
- Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») are the only ones authorized (and registered for this purpose) to exchange invoices falling within the scope of "e-invoicing" scope (domestic B2B invoices between VAT-registered entities in France or B2G/G2B between a VAT-registered entity and a public body), and to transmit flows 1, flows 10 (e-reporting) and so-called "mandatory" statuses to the PPF Data Concentrator.
- OD/SC (Compatible Solutions) (Dematerialization Operators) are service providers or management solutions upstream and downstream of invoice exchange and life cycles, and can act as an interface between the various Parties described above and the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»).
- The PPF (Public Invoicing Portal) is responsible for the Directory of Taxable Entities and their electronic invoicing addresses and the Data Concentrator (CdD PPF), i.e., for receiving Flow 1, Flow 10, and Flow 6 for Mandatory statuses (Submitted, Rejected, Refused, Payment Received).

4.1.2 Presentation of the annexes used in the use case

The use cases described in this document are based on the documents describing invoice formats and life cycle messages published by AFNOR (XP Z12-012). The semantic format of the invoice is described according to two profiles:

- An EN16931 profile compliant with the EN16931 standard, to which a few additional management rules have been added to take into account the management rules defined in the annexes to the external specifications version 3.1.
- An EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile, which is an extension as permitted by the EN16931 standard, containing additional data referenced using naming conventions such as "EXT-FR-FE-BG-XX" for data blocks and "EXT-FR-FE-XX" for data. In addition, certain management rules in the EN16931 standard have been removed or replaced by more flexible rules for this profile.

Reference may also be made to the annexes of the external specifications in force published on the impots.gouv.fr website:

- **Annex 1 (Excel format):** this annex defines the semantic format of Data Flow 1 required by the tax authorities.
- **Annex 2 (Excel format):** this annex defines the semantic format of the life cycle of flows and business objects (Directory, e-reporting, e-invoicing) and its use in exchanges between Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») and the PPF.
- **Annex 3 (Excel format):** this annex defines the semantic format of the directory used to create or modify entries in the directory of VAT-registered entities, i.e. the electronic invoicing addresses of invoice recipients.
- **Annex 6 (Excel format):** this annex defines the semantic format for e-reporting of transaction and payment data.
- **Annex 7 (Excel format):** this annex defines all the management rules for all business objects exchanged between the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») and the PPF described in the above annexes.

4.1.3 Presentation of invoices taken into account in use cases

In the context of the dematerialized exchange of domestic B2B invoices, several types of invoices are taken into account (see management rule BR-FR-04 in the description of invoice formats):

- Simple invoices;
- pre-payment invoices;

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- Factored invoices;
- Self-billed invoices (when the BUYER creates the invoice on behalf of the SELLER and sends it to them);
- Corrected invoices, which are invoices that cancel and replace a previous invoice. They are therefore both a credit note on the previous referenced invoice and a new invoice;
- Credit notes.
- Multi-seller invoices, only with the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile (or EXTENDED from Factur-X), which is an invoice created by a transparent intermediary on behalf of several SELLERS and sent to a single BUYER, with payment centralized to a single payee (usually the transparent intermediary, who can invoice their own services on the same invoice).

4.1.4 Presentation of invoicing electronic addresses and their link to the Directory (“Annuaire”)

All Parties involved in an invoice have an electronic address, which is to the electronic invoice what the postal address is to the paper invoice, i.e., data that allows an electronic message (an invoice, a life cycle status) to be sent to the party referencing its electronic address.

4.1.4.1 invoices and lifecycle statuses?

These electronic addresses are composed of an addressing identifier belonging to a given repository, qualified through an identification scheme (SchemeID), to be chosen from a list: the EAS (Electronic Address Scheme) list, available in Standard EN16931 and referenced in Annex A of Standard XP Z12-012. Some electronic addresses are linked to different exchange protocols, such as the "EM" schemeID for an SMTP address (an email: xxx@nomdedomaine.xx), or "AQ" for an X400 electronic address. Most other types can be used in point-to-point exchanges between platforms and, more generally, in interoperable network exchanges such as PEPPOL.

These addresses are therefore often written in the form "schemeID:Address_Identifier," for example:

- 0088:GLN: address using a GLN-type addressing identifier.
- 0060:DUNS: address using a DUNS-type addressing identifier.
- 9957:TVAINTRAFR: address using an addressing identifier corresponding to a French intra-community VAT number.
- 0199:GLEIF: address using a Global Legal Entity Identifier address identifier.
- ...
- And 0225:SIREN or 0225:SIREN_XXX: address using a SIREN (legal identifier in France) or SIREN_XXX addressing identifier, where XXX is either free (and is called SUFFIX) or in SIRET or SIRET_CODE_ROUTAGE form, provided that the SIRET and CODE_ROUTAGE are present in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»).

4.1.4.2 The PPF Directory («Annuaire») and the use of electronic addresses

The PPF Directory («Annuaire») contains ALL electronic addresses under schemeID 0225 intended to receive invoices for entities SUBJECT to VAT or public entities. Thus, if an electronic address is present in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»), it means that the recipient is subject to VAT or is a public entity. There are therefore entities with a SIREN number (such as associations) that may not be subject to VAT and will not be listed in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»), nor will any of their electronic addresses of the type 0225:SIREN_XXX.

It is therefore also possible that there are electronic addresses under schemeID 0225, i.e., beginning with a SIREN number, that are not in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»). Beyond the above example of a non-VAT-registered association with a SIREN number, a VAT-registered company that wishes to channel the life cycle status of its issued invoices can enter a 0225:SIREN_STATUS in its invoice for itself (BT-34 for the SELLER, for example), without having referenced it in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»). It can then be used in the PEPPOL network so that the life cycle return statuses are sent to it at this address, but it will not be able to receive invoices falling within the scope of e-invoicing.

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Thus, in a "traditional" invoice exchange (i.e., not self-billing):

- The BUYER's electronic address in BT-49 is the electronic address to which the invoice must be sent.
- The SELLER's electronic address in BT-34 is the electronic address at which the SELLER wishes to receive its statuses, particularly when it uses interoperability between Approved Platforms ("Plateformes Agréées") in a network for which electronic addresses (also known as "EndPoints") are the keys enabling automated exchanges between platforms (known as "dynamic discovery"). There is no obligation for these life cycle status return addresses to be in the PPF Directory ("Annuaire"), or even under schemeID 0225, as only the invoice receipt addresses for VAT-registered entities in France must be (and it is not necessarily desirable to receive invoices at the same address as these status returns for issued invoices).
- The electronic addresses of the other parties (Payee, Seller's Agent, Buyer's Agent, Payer, etc.) may be used if it is necessary to reply to them with statuses or invoices in order to integrate them into the invoice life cycle. They are not necessarily in the form 0225:SIREN_XXX (particularly for international players not established in France).

Section 1.4.5 details how to choose these addresses and the impact of changing Authorized Platforms, both for sending and receiving.

That said, all VAT-registered entities with a SIREN number are listed in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»). In order to enable the transmission of invoices through the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») chosen by each taxable entity, invoice recipients (generally BUYERS, but also SELLERS in the case of self-billing) **MUST define one or more electronic invoicing addresses under SchemeID 0225** and have them registered in the PPF Directory («Annuaire») by the PA-R they have designated to receive their invoices at this electronic invoicing address on their behalf. Those who practice self-billing may choose the same electronic invoicing address for receiving invoices as the one they use to receive their purchase invoices, and it is up to them and their PA-R to then distinguish between the flows. They may also dedicate an electronic invoicing address to self-billed invoices, for example 0225:SIREN_AUTOFACTURE.

These electronic invoicing addresses are the identifier for the address line described in Annex 3 of the external specifications (data DT-7-5-1), and must take one of the following forms:

- **"SIREN"** of the legal entity. This is the most common address used by companies (especially when they only have one).
- **"SIREN_SIRET"**: if the company has chosen to create electronic invoicing addresses for one of its establishments, which must itself be active and listed in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»). This address structure is primarily intended for public sector entities that are referenced by a SIRET number.
- **"SIREN_SIRET_CODEROUTAGE"**: if the company has chosen to create electronic addresses at a more granular level than its establishment. This ROUTING_CODE must be configured in advance in the PPF Directory («Annuaire») and must be active and linked to the SIRET number of the address. This address structure is primarily intended for public sector entities that may need to have "SERVICE EXECUTANT" CODES in order to distribute invoices to the correct departments.
- **"SIREN_SUFFIX"**: if the company wishes to have several electronic invoicing addresses, for example to differentiate between purchasing channels, because it has chosen several Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») (bearing in mind that an electronic invoicing address can only be associated with a single Accredited Platform on reception side), without having to link these addresses to an internal organization (ROUTING_CODE) or the location of its teams (SIRET). SUFFIXES are freely chosen by the company. They do not need to be created in advance in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»). They are simply part of the electronic invoicing address. **It is therefore this type of address that will be recommended and described in this document for certain use cases.**

Electronic invoicing addresses for receiving invoices are listed in the PPF Directory («Annuaire»), which can be viewed publicly via the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») or the PPF Portal, available for public consultation at <https://portail.chorus-pro.gouv.fr>. This means that once you know your customers' SIREN numbers, you can find all their electronic invoicing addresses. You then simply need to enter them on your invoices to ensure they reach your customers reliably and can be tracked using life cycle statuses. **The**

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electronic invoicing address is therefore essential customer data that needs to be managed within your information system. Even though it often takes the form of the company's SIREN number, it is important to distinguish between the customer's SIREN number, which is a legal identifier, and the customer's electronic invoicing address, even if it happens to be the same as the SIREN number.

Invoices must therefore contain the recipient's electronic invoicing address (BUYER or SELLER for self-billed invoices), as well as that of the issuer (SELLER or BUYER for self-billed invoices), in order to manage life cycle status returns. Thanks to this electronic invoicing address and the PPF Directory («Annuaire»), Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») can interoperate automatically, in particular through the PEPPOL network under the governance of the PEPPOL France Authority.

All invoices that fall within the scope of "e-invoicing" MUST contain an electronic invoicing address under schemeID 0225 for the invoice recipient, i.e., for the BUYER (BT-49) for traditional invoices, and for the SELLER (BT-34) for self-billed invoices.

For those who use the PEPPOL network, their electronic invoicing addresses are also available to receive invoices from entities not subject to VAT in France, starting with international entities using PEPPOL for international B2B invoices.

4.1.4.3 What happens to a VAT Registered entity not listed in the PPF Directory (“Annuaire”)?

Some VAT taxable entities do not appear (or do not yet appear) in the PPF Directory (“Annuaire”). In this case, they may be considered “not subject to VAT” by the issuers of invoices addressed to them, which means that these issuers are no longer subject to the obligation to send electronic invoices to recipients and can switch to the B2C e-reporting component of the reform for these transactions (e-reporting of B2C transactions of daily turnover totals by transaction category).

This tolerance also applies to the penalty system: when an entity is not yet included in the recipient directory due to the administration's own validation procedures or technical difficulties attributable to the administration, it will not be penalized if it does not choose an accredited platform.

The suppliers subject to these entities will also not be penalized if they do not issue electronic invoices to entities not yet included in the directory. Suppliers will have to carry out e-reporting as if they were invoicing an entity not subject to tax (flow 10.3 and, where applicable, 10.4 if VAT is due on receipt).

4.1.4.4 How to send an invoice to a VAT Registered listed in the PPF Directory “Annuaire” but without any choice of an Accredited Platform

Some VAT taxable entities appear in the directory but without an active invoicing electronic address, i.e., one connected to an Accredited Platform. In this case, the issuing taxable entity remains subject to the electronic invoicing obligation using the electronic invoicing address listed in the directory (the one corresponding to the SIREN number). Their Accredited Platform can then carry out all the regulatory checks and send a "Submitted" status to the PPF, with the reason "NON_TRANSMISE" (NOT_SENT) in order to alert the tax authorities that the recipient has not chosen an Accredited Platform.

The issuer can then contact their customer to send them a duplicate invoice, for example, and get paid.

The recipient cannot demand a paper or even PDF invoice, as regulations require them to accept electronic invoices and choose an accredited platform. They therefore find themselves in the same situation as if they had not received a paper invoice, which they may have lost. They then rely on a duplicate. If necessary, if they act quickly, the Approved Issuing Platform may be able to resend the transmission so that their invoices reach them.

4.1.4.5 How to choose these electronic addresses and what are the consequences if you change your Approved Platform

The choice of electronic addresses depends on the company's situation, its size, whether it faces certain specific use cases that may require gathering related invoices, or its invoice processing organization.

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4.1.4.5.1 *Electronic addresses for receiving invoices*

Firstly, for electronic addresses used to receive invoices, it is recommended that you choose one or more addresses that are as permanent as possible, as each change requires you to notify all the suppliers concerned, which causes a certain amount of disruption. As a result, for example, the SIRET network (and therefore also SIRET_CODE_ROUTAGE) does not comply with this principle, since a simple change of address results in a change of SIRET and should therefore be avoided.

It is therefore preferable to choose a limited number of SIREN_SUFFIXE electronic addresses, i.e., electronic addresses corresponding to specific processing requirements. For example, a company that has to manage significant employee expenses may want all resulting invoices to be sent to a dedicated electronic address, because the suppliers are not known in advance and because those invoices are often already paid. Similarly, a company that uses several applications to manage its purchase invoices (e.g., several ERPs, specialized solutions for certain purchases, etc.) may wish to use several invoice receipt electronic addresses as gateways for its various invoicing channels.

A small business that manages few invoices can make do with a single electronic address (and therefore SIREN). A retailer who has several stores and wants to differentiate invoices by store can create dedicated electronic addresses with a SUFFIX to make them more clearly identifiable to suppliers.

It is very bad practice to multiply electronic addresses by recipient within the company or by validator or purchaser department, firstly because this multiplies them, but also because organizations change regularly, as do people, and updating an organizational repository is often complex and time-consuming.

A good illustration of these principles is to consider that electronic addresses for receiving invoices are different entry points into the company, and that internal circulation within departments must be based on the references present in the invoices (order number, contract number, delivery note, buyer references, or even, where applicable, a SIRET number as a reference only, which does not require changing the electronic address for a simple physical move, etc.).

In the event of a change of Accredited Platform (« Plateforme Agréée ») for the electronic address for receiving invoices, all invoices issued after the date of change will arrive on the new Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée"), and all processing life cycle statuses issued by the issuer ("completed " and "Paiement Received") for invoices issued before the change of Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée") will arrive on the new Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée"), which will be responsible for forwarding them to the recipient, who will then be able to respond to them on their old Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée", thanks to the minimum service being maintained for 12 months after the change of AP, as described in the regulations).

4.1.4.5.2 *Electronic addresses for receiving the life cycle statuses of issued invoices*

When it comes to issuers' electronic addresses, which are in fact electronic addresses for receiving the life cycle statuses of issued invoices, it is also important not to multiply them unnecessarily, but to organize them according to customer invoicing processes.

It may make sense to use one or more electronic addresses dedicated to receiving the life cycle statuses of issued invoices, which are different from electronic addresses used to receive invoices. However, a small business which processes an average of fewer than 400 invoices per year, including just over a hundred issued invoices, can make do with a single electronic address (e.g., its SIREN number) for issuing invoices (and therefore receiving the life cycle statuses of its issued invoices) and for receiving its electronic invoices.

In the event of a change in the Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée") for issuing electronic invoices, the life cycle statuses transmitted by the recipients (i.e., all those relating to the recipient's processing of invoices) will arrive at the Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée") responsible for the issuer's electronic address (the Seller in the case of non-self-billed invoices) entered in the invoices issued.

There are therefore three possible solutions:

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- Keep the same electronic address for receiving the life cycle statuses of invoices issued after the change of Accredited Platform ('Plateforme Agréée') and entrust it to the new Accredited Platform: the statuses of invoices issued with the old PA-E will arrive at the new PA-E, which will be able to transmit them to the issuer of the invoices without reconciling them with the invoices since it will not have issued them. It may also offer a service to redirect these statuses to the old PA-E.
- Change the electronic address for receiving the life cycle statuses of invoices issued for new invoices and entrust it to the new PA-E, while keeping the old address with the old PA-E: The statuses of invoices sent with the old PA-E arrive at the old PA-E, and those corresponding to invoices issued with the new PA-E (and the new electronic address for issuance) arrive at the new PA-E.
- For e-invoicing platforms which use PEPPOL, the electronic addresses for receiving return statuses are entered in an envelope (SBDH) in which the invoice is inserted. This e-invoicing platform may propose to replace the electronic address of the invoice issuer in the SBDH envelope with an electronic address which it controls to ensure that it always receives the statuses of the invoices it processes for issuance, while ensuring that the life cycle statuses are reassigned to each user's invoices.

For a company which processes few invoices and has a single electronic address for sending and receiving, the first approach is the simplest and least disruptive in the event of a change, given the small number of invoices involved.

For a company which decides to dedicate electronic addresses for receiving, the second option is the most effective.

4.1.4.5.3 Case of self-billing

Self-billing invoices are invoices issued by the BUYER to the SELLER, under an invoicing mandate given by the SELLER to the BUYER. This is often implemented in order to simplify invoice processing from the BUYER's point of view, both for the BUYER, who is often in agreement with himself, and for the SELLER, who does not have to create his invoices, but just to record them.

These invoices are clearly identified by the invoice type code (BT-3). They must then be processed by the Approved Issuing Platforms (PA-E) on the BUYER's side to the Approved Receiving Platforms (PA-R) of the SELLERS.

In terms of electronic invoice receipt addresses, the one in the SELLER block (in BT-34) is therefore used. The SELLER may decide to use the same electronic address as for receiving their purchase invoices, but it is their responsibility to clearly distinguish their purchase invoices from their self-billed sales invoices.

They may also decide to create a dedicated electronic address for receiving invoices (e.g., 0225:SIREN_AUTOFACTURATION), which they entrust to the Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Agréée") of their choice. For a VAT Registered subject to the obligation to receive electronic invoices, this electronic address must be under schemeID 0225 and be listed in the PPF Directory ("Annuaire"). As a reminder (see use case 19b described in Annex A), it is up to the PA-E on the BUYER side to create flow 1 and transmit it to the PPF.

The same applies to the electronic address for receiving the life cycle statuses of issued invoices, i.e., use the same address as for all issued sales invoices, or dedicate an electronic address for the return statuses of issued self-billed invoices (to be entered in invoices in BT-49).

PLEASE NOTE: in this case, all life cycle statuses are reversed between BUYER and SELLER, except for payment statuses. The BUYER remains the one who transmits the "Payment Sent" status and the SELLER remains the one who transmits the "Payment Received" status.

4.1.5 Application of Standard XP Z12-014

The XP Z12-014 standard and its annexes are intended to describe the use cases identified, how they can be implemented within the framework of the Reform, and the respective obligations of Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»), OD/SC (Compatible Solutions) and companies for each use case, as well as certain additional optional features that could be implemented to provide added value.

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The nominal case and the management of life cycle statuses and settlements with Credit Notes or Corrected Invoices are part of the obligations of all Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»).

However, unless specifically required by regulation, the implementation of the use cases described in Chapter 3 of Annex A is a matter for the commercial policy of the economic actors (Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»), OD/SC (-Compatible Solution)), which are therefore under no obligation to be able to handle all use cases. It is also likely that some Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») will specialize in managing certain of these use cases.

Nevertheless, this list of use cases constitutes a functional reference framework that can help establish comparison grids for the offerings of different Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»), Compatible Solutions, or other ODs.

4.2 Description of the nominal case of invoice exchange

4.2.1 Transmission of an invoice and life cycle

Before describing specific use cases, it is important to start with the nominal case of a SELLER who invoices their customer, the BUYER, through the PA-E of the invoice issuer (in this case, the SELLER) and the PA-R of the BUYER.

This invoice exchange is accompanied by life cycle statuses, first in a transmission phase (statuses created by the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») for end users to track end-to-end transmission), then in a processing phase where end users can create statuses to be transmitted to their counterparties through the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»).

The **transmission** statuses (**Submitted/Rejected on issue, Issued, Received/Rejected on receipt, Made available**) allow the progress of the invoice to be tracked in this order. **Processing** statuses (**Rejected, Disputed, Suspended, Completed, Approved, Partially Approved, Payment Transmitted, Cashed**) can be set independently. Analysis of use cases may lead to the addition of useful processing statuses for some of them. The first of these is a "Cancelled" status to be assigned to an invoice which has been corrected, either by the SELLER when issuing the Corrected Invoice, or by the BUYER when processing the Corrected Invoice, to indicate that this initial invoice has been replaced and to close its life cycle.

As a reminder, **four** of these statuses are **"mandatory,"** meaning they must be transmitted to the CdD PPF for the tax authorities, namely **"Submitted" ("Déposée"), "Rejected ("Rejetée"), "Refused" (zRefusée) and "Payment Received" ("Encaissée")** which is necessary to prepare the VAT pre-fill.

Finally, the **"Payment Received" status must be sent to the tax authorities only if VAT is due upon receipt of payment** (service invoices for which the SELLER has not opted for debits). This also applies **to advance payment invoices, whether for goods or services, for which VAT is payable upon payment of the advance**, even if the taxable entity has opted for debits.

It is also possible for the SELLER to transmit the "Received" status even when VAT is not due upon receipt, but in this case, it is only transmitted to the BUYER (and not to the tax authorities via the CdD PPF).

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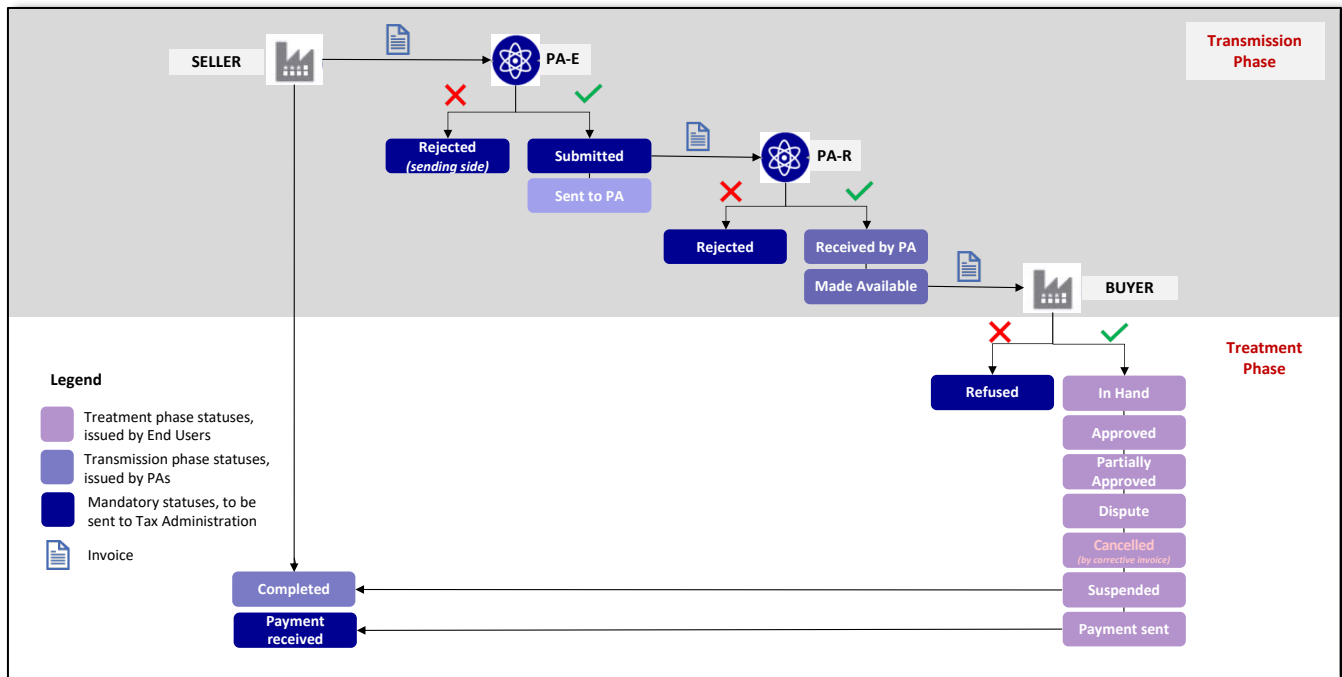


Figure 1 : Illustration of the life cycle and different statuses

Analysis of use cases shows that it will be necessary to provide additional complementary statuses to support processing, such as "Invoiced," "Confidential Invoiced," "Not Invoiced," "Direct Payment Request," etc.

The processing of invoices issued by the PA-E and received by the PA-R involves several steps:

- **Technical checks:** antivirus, empty files, envelope checks, etc. In the event of an error, an UNACCEPTABLE status ("IRRECEVABLE", Code 501) is sent to the issuer, with the reason (see list in Annex A of standard XP Z12-012). The issuer can then correct the invoice and resend it.
- **"Application" checks:** format structure. For XML formats, this corresponds to the xsd check. At this stage, the file is recognized as an invoice. In the event of an error, an UNACCEPTABLE status ("IRRECEVABLE", Code 501) is sent to the issuer, with the reason (see list in Annex A of standard XP Z12-012). The issuer can then correct the error and resend the file. If the checks do not detect any errors, the document is recognized and can be processed.
- **Functional checks:** management rules, corresponding first to the profile (EN16931, EXTENDED-CTC-FR, BASIC WL, etc.), then to the management rules specific to the reform, as described in Standard XP Z12-012. Then checks for duplicates, addresses, and the "reachability" of the electronic invoicing address for receiving invoices. At the end of this last phase, the statuses are as follows:
 - ✓ In the case of processing upon issuance (PA-E), the status is either "Rejected" in the event of an error, with the associated reason, or "Submitted." They are transmitted to the PPF and made available to the issuer (the SELLER and the BUYER for self-billed invoices).
 - ✓ In the case of processing on receipt, the status is either "Rejected" in the event of an error, with the associated reason, or "Received." The "Rejected" status is sent to the PPF and the PA-E and made available to the recipient. The "Received" status is sent to the Issuer (via the PA-E) and made available to the Recipient. The transmission phase ends with the status "Made Available," which means that the Recipient has received the invoice or a notification of receipt of the invoice. This status is transmitted to the Issuer (via the PA-E) and made available to the Recipient.

When invoices are exchanged in batches, i.e., in packages, usually in an envelope that provides some description of the contents, an initial flow control step is necessary, beginning with a technical check, followed by a breakdown by "business object" file (in this case, invoices) and a unit application check. If one of the "business object" files in the batch contains an error (does not comply with the file structure), the most common practice (and that used in exchanges with the PPF, for example) is to declare the entire batch "UNACCEPTABLE" ("IRRECEVABLE") so that the sender can reconstruct it and resend it. The other practice is to identify what is in error (or what has been received correctly) and let the issuer correct and resend what is

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in error. If the check is positive, the batch can be given an "ACCEPTABLE" status (Code 500). The "ACCEPTABLE" (Code 500) or "UNACCEPTABLE" (Code 501) batch statuses can be transmitted via a life cycle message.

For the sake of completeness, it may happen that the PA-E transmits an invoice to a PA-R that is not responsible for the recipient's electronic invoicing address, either due to an error in consulting the directory on the PA-E side or, in the event of a recent change of PA-R, a problem with updating the directory. In this case, to avoid setting a "Rejected" status, which would require canceling the invoice and creating a new one, the PA-R must issue an "ERROR_ROUTING" status (Code 221) to the PA-E, which can then retry the transmission after updating the directory or consulting/synchronizing it.

The steps in the nominal case are as follows, organized into seven steps, the numbering of which will be retained throughout the description of the various use cases:

Step	Step name	Responsible actor	Description
1	Creation of the invoice for the BUYER	SELLER	Following a commercial transaction (order/delivery, service contract, spot purchase, etc.), the SELLER creates the invoice (flow 2) via its information system. It can entrust the creation of the invoice to an OD/SC (Compatible Solution) or to its PA-E. It sends it to its PA-E for processing.
2	Transmission of flow 1, the invoice (flow 2), and related statuses	PA-E	Once the PA-E has carried out the regulatory compliance checks, including checks for duplicates and the existence of an active electronic invoicing address for the recipient, it MUST transmit the data required by the Administration (flow 1) to the CdD PPF. It MUST also transmit the invoice (flow 2 or flow 3) to the PA-R of the BUYER. It must send the status "Submitted" to the CdD PPF.
3	Receipt of the invoice	PA-R	The BUYER's platform (PA-R) receives the invoice (flow 2 or flow 3), performs the regulatory checks, creates the transmission statuses (here "Received," then "Made Available") and makes the invoice available to the BUYER for processing.
4a 4b	Processing of the invoice and updating of statuses prior to payment	BUYER	The BUYER processes the invoice and sets the corresponding processing statuses in its PA-R ("Rejected," "Accepted," "In dispute," "Approved," "Partially approved," "Suspended," etc.) for transmission to the SELLER via its PA-E.
4c	Receipt of invoice statuses	SELLER	The SELLER receives the invoice statuses following processing of the invoice by the BUYER in accordance with the terms of the life cycle. If a "Suspended" status is received, the SELLER may send a "Completed" status containing the necessary additional information.
5a 5b	Payment of the invoice Creation and transmission of the "Payment transmitted" status	BUYER / PA-R	The BUYER pays the invoice to the SELLER. They can send a "Payment Sent" status to the SELLER via PA-R (recommended).
5c	Receipt of "Payment Transmitted" status	SELLER / PA-E	The SELLER receives the "Payment Transmitted" status from their PA-E.
6a	Invoice payment receipt	SELLER	The SELLER receives payment for the invoice (outside the circuit).
6b	Issuance of "Payment Received" status	SELLER / PA-E	If the VAT on the invoice is payable upon receipt, the SELLER creates the "Payment Received" status and transmits it to the CdD PPF via its PA-E. The PA-E also transmits the "Payment Received" status to the PA-R for the attention of the BUYER.
6c	Receipt of "Payment Received" status by the BUYER	BUYER PA-R	The BUYER receives the "Received" status.

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Step	Step name	Responsible actor	Description
7	Receipt of "Payment Received" status by the PPF CdD	PPF Data Concentrator	The PPF Data Concentrator (CdD PPF) receives the "Payment Received" status.

The "Payment Transmitted" status indicates the amount paid using block MDG-43 of the life cycle message, if applicable with details of the applicable VAT rate (optional, requiring several iterations if multiple VAT rates apply), as follows:

- MDT-207 (Data Type Code): MPA (meaning "Amount Paid").
- MDT-215 (Amount): the amount paid with VAT.
- MDT-224: applicable VAT rate (optional, only if the BUYER wishes to inform the SELLER of the applicable VAT details in their payment).

The "Received" status MUST indicate the amount(s) received by applicable VAT rate, as follows:

- MDT-207 (Data type code): MEN (meaning "Amount received (with VAT)").
- MDT-215 (Amount): the Payment Amount Received with VAT.
- MDT-224: the VAT rate applicable to the amount received with VAT.

Example: an invoice for €1,160 with VAT, of which €600 without VAT at 20% VAT (€120) and €400 without VAT at 10% (€40):

- MDG-43 (1st occurrence):
 - ✓ MDT-207 (Data type code): MEN (meaning "Amount received (with VAT)").
 - ✓ MDT-215 (Amount): 720
 - ✓ MDT-224: 20
- MDG-43 (2nd occurrence):
 - ✓ MDT-207 (Data type code): MEN (meaning "Amount received (with VAT)").
 - ✓ MDT-215 (Amount): 440
 - ✓ MDT-224: 10

The diagram below illustrates the mechanics of invoice transmission and its life cycle. The white blocks represent the exchange of electronic invoices, life cycle statuses, and invoicing data (flow 1) that PA-E or PA-R issue or receive on behalf of their respective customers.

The gray blocks correspond to actions or steps that are outside the scope of PA-E and PA-R.

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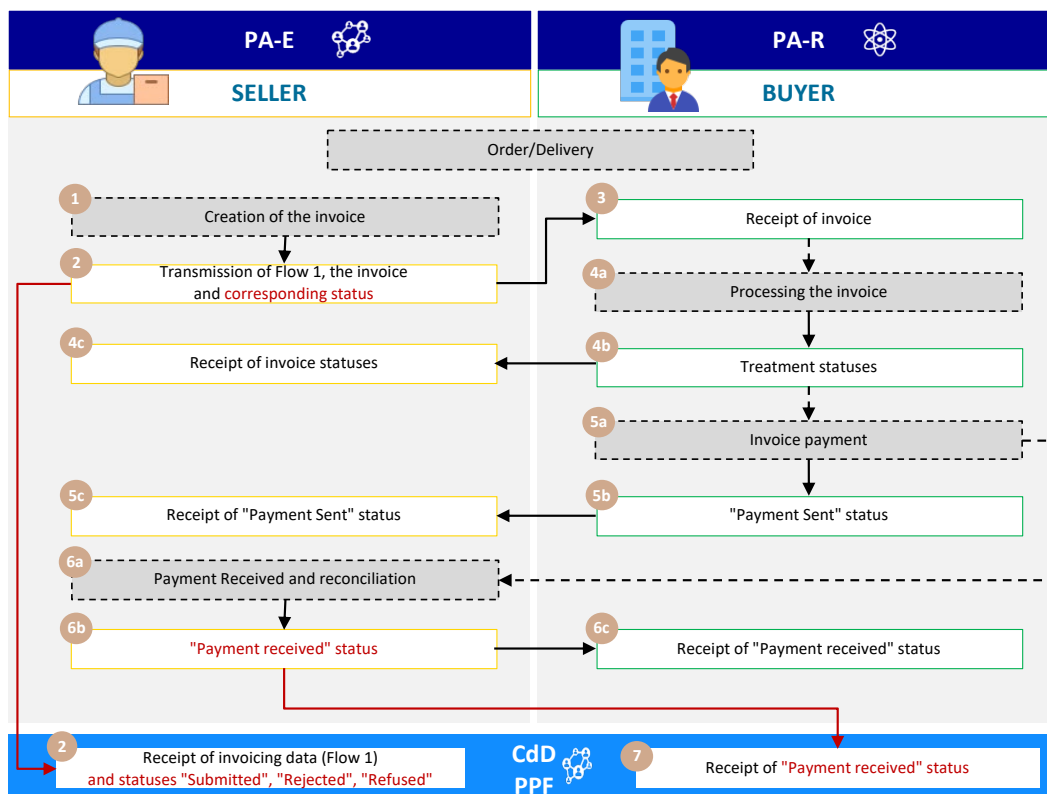


Figure 2 : nominal case of invoice exchange

With regard to the life cycle, each Accredited Platform is required to:

- Create the transmission phase statuses and make them available to their customers ("Rejected upon issuance" / "Submitted", "Sent", for the PA-E; "Rejected on receipt" / "Received", "Made available" for the PA-R).
- To transmit the statuses of the transmission phase to the Accredited Platform of the Counterparty, EXCEPT for the statuses "Sent" / "Submitted" and "Rejected" upon issuance, when set by the PA-E in charge of processing the issuance.
- To transmit to the Accredited Platform of the Counterparty the statuses it receives from its users or that its users create on the Accredited Platform.
- To make available to its users the life cycle statuses it has received from the Accredited Platform of the Counterparty or which it has set itself during the transmission phase.
- To transmit to the PPF Data Concentrator (CdD), for invoices subject to e-invoicing, the mandatory statuses ("Submitted", "Rejected" (on issue or on receipt), "Refused", "Payment Received" when VAT is due on payment receipt), as well as flow 1 of the data required by the tax authorities for the PA-E in charge of processing on issue.

With regard to the life cycle, businesses subject to the reform are required to:

- Choose a reason for the "Refused" status from the list of usable reasons described in the description of the minimum base formats and profiles for invoices and life cycle statuses.
- Create, or have created on their behalf, a "Payment Received" status for each partial or total payment receipt of an invoice within the scope of the reform following payment of that invoice by the BUYER or by a third party on their behalf, when VAT is due upon receipt.

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4.3 Rejection upon issuance

If any of the regulatory checks results in an error, the PA-E MUST reject the invoice. It creates the status "Rejected" (code 213), for which a reason must be given to explain the reason for the REJECTION. This status MUST be transmitted to the PPF Data Concentrator. It MUST NOT be transmitted to the invoice recipient. It MUST be made available to the SELLER (the issuer).

Step	Step name	Responsible actor	Description
1	Creation of the invoice for the BUYER	SELLER	Following a commercial transaction (order/delivery, service contract, spot purchase, etc.), the SELLER creates the invoice (flow 2) via its information system. It may entrust the creation of the invoice to an OD/SC (Compatible Solution) or to its PA-E. It sends it to its PA-E for processing.
2	Rejection of the invoice and transmission of the "Rejected" status to the CdD PPF	PA-E	The PA-E has detected an error in the regulatory checks it is required to perform, including checking for duplicates with invoices it has already processed on behalf of the SELLER. It creates a "Rejected" status, which it sends to the CdD PPF and makes available to the SELLER.
1b	The SELLER cancels the rejected invoice in its accounts.	SELLER PA-E	The SELLER cancels the rejected invoice in its accounts, for example by creating an INTERNAL CREDIT NOTE (i.e., not sent to the recipient who did not receive the rejected invoice). It does not send it to its PA-E, except for archiving purposes only, if applicable. If the PA-E receives a CREDIT NOTE from the SELLER referring to a Rejected invoice, it MUST NOT forward it to the BUYER, nor send a 1 flow to the CdD PPF.

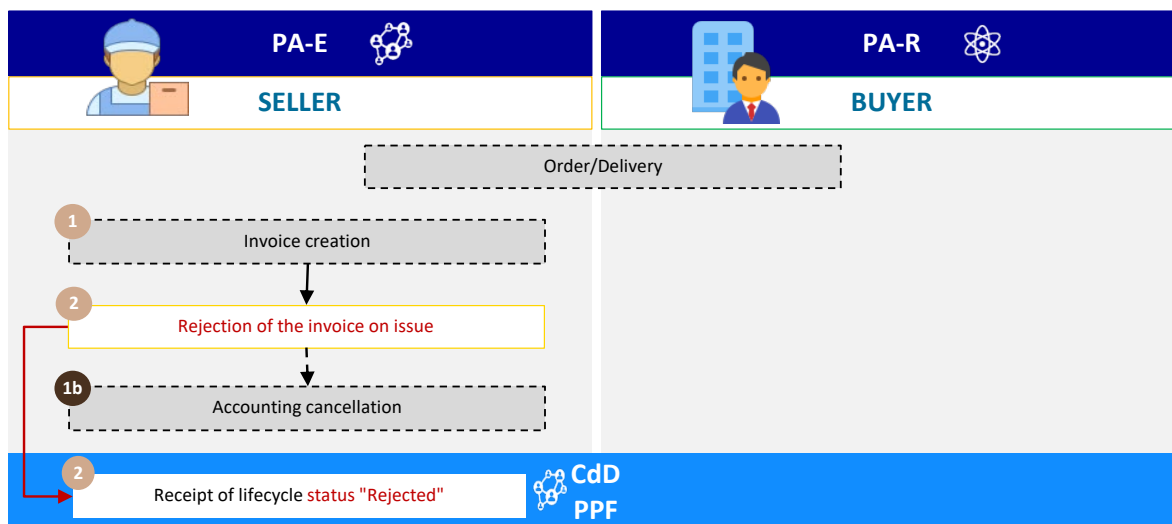


Figure3: Rejection upon issuance of an e-invoice

Obligations of the PA-E in the event of rejection upon issuance:

- **Set the status to "Rejected," with a reason for rejection from the list of applicable reasons, send it to the CdD PPF, and make it available to the SELLER.**

Optional PA-E features in the event of rejection upon issuance:

- **If the SELLER sends its PA-E a CREDIT NOTE referring to an initial Rejected invoice referenced in BG-3 (reference to a previous invoice), the PA-E does not send the CREDIT NOTE to the BUYER and does not send a flow 1 of this credit note to the CdD PPF.**

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SELLER obligations in the event of Rejection on issue:

- **The SELLER MUST cancel the posting of an invoice that has been given a "Rejected" status by the PA-E, for example by creating an INTERNAL CREDIT NOTE that is not sent to the PA-E, based on the "Rejected" life cycle status, or sent to its PA-E for archiving purposes only and not for transmission.**

4.4 Compliant invoice but not transmitted due to the recipient not choosing an Accredited Platform

It may happen that the recipient subject to VAT, listed in the directory, has not chosen an Accredited Platform. This can be verified by consulting the PPF Directory («Annuaire») in advance. The recipient has at least one inactive SIREN address. In this case, the SELLER may use this inactive electronic address listed in the directory (since no other address is active) and send it to their PA-E.

The PA-E will carry out the various checks and may create a "Submitted" status and transmit flow 1 and this "Submitted" status to the PPF's CdD. In this case, the "Submitted" status must contain a REASON "NOT_TRANSMITTED" to indicate to the PPF (and the tax authorities) that the BUYER does not have the necessary equipment.

As a reminder, the draft finance bill for 2026 provides for a quarterly penalty if it is found each quarter that a taxable entity is not equipped with at least one electronic invoicing address for receiving invoices, subject to its adoption.

The situation is then strictly the same as that of a paper invoice (or even a PDF invoice) not received by the BUYER. The SELLER should contact their customer and, if necessary, send them a duplicate of the invoice (e.g., a legible representation of it).

The BUYER cannot then demand a paper or PDF invoice, as it is the BUYER who is at fault for not receiving it.

Once the BUYER is equipped, the PA-E may, if it wishes to offer this service, for a period of time that it determines, resend the "NOT_SENT" invoices so that they reach the BUYER normally.

In any case, the SELLER must, if necessary, file a "Payment Received" status if VAT is due upon payment receipt. However, the BUYER cannot file a "Rejected" status since it is not connected to an Accredited Platform. This does not prevent the invoice from being processed, as was the case before the reform was implemented.

Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
1	Creation of the invoice for the BUYER	SELLER	Following a commercial transaction (order/delivery, service contract, spot purchase, etc.), the SELLER creates the invoice (flow 2) via its information system. It can entrust the creation of the invoice to an OD/SC (Compatible Solution) or to its PA-E. It sends it to its PA-E for processing.
2	Transmission of flow 1 and "Submitted" status	PA-E	Having carried out the regulatory compliance checks, including duplicate checks, the PA-E finds that there is no active electronic invoicing address (connected to a PA). It MUST create the status "Submitted" with the reason "NOT_TRANSMITTED" and send it to the CdD of the PPF, along with the data required by the Administration (flow 1). It MUST also make the "Submitted" status with the reason "NOT_TRANSMITTED" available to the SELLER.
3	The SELLER contacts the BUYER to obtain payment	SELLER	The SELLER contacts the BUYER as in the case of an unpaid invoice, except that they know immediately that the BUYER has not received the invoice through no fault of their own.

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Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
			They may send a duplicate invoice by any means. They are not required to issue another invoice by any means other than sending an electronic invoice through their PA-E. Nor are they required to cancel their invoice (in this case by issuing a credit note treated in the same way as their invoice) and create a new one once the BUYER is equipped.
4 and 5	Processing of the invoice	BUYER	The BUYER and the SELLER process the invoice, which is paid.
6a and 6b	Payment receipt and "Payment received" status	SELLER / PA-E	If the VAT on the invoice is payable upon payment receipt, the SELLER creates the "Payment Received" status and transmits it to the PPF CdD via its PA-E.
7	Receipt of "Payment Received" status by the PPF CdD	PPF Data Concentrator	The PPF Data Concentrator (CdD PPF) receives the "Received" status.

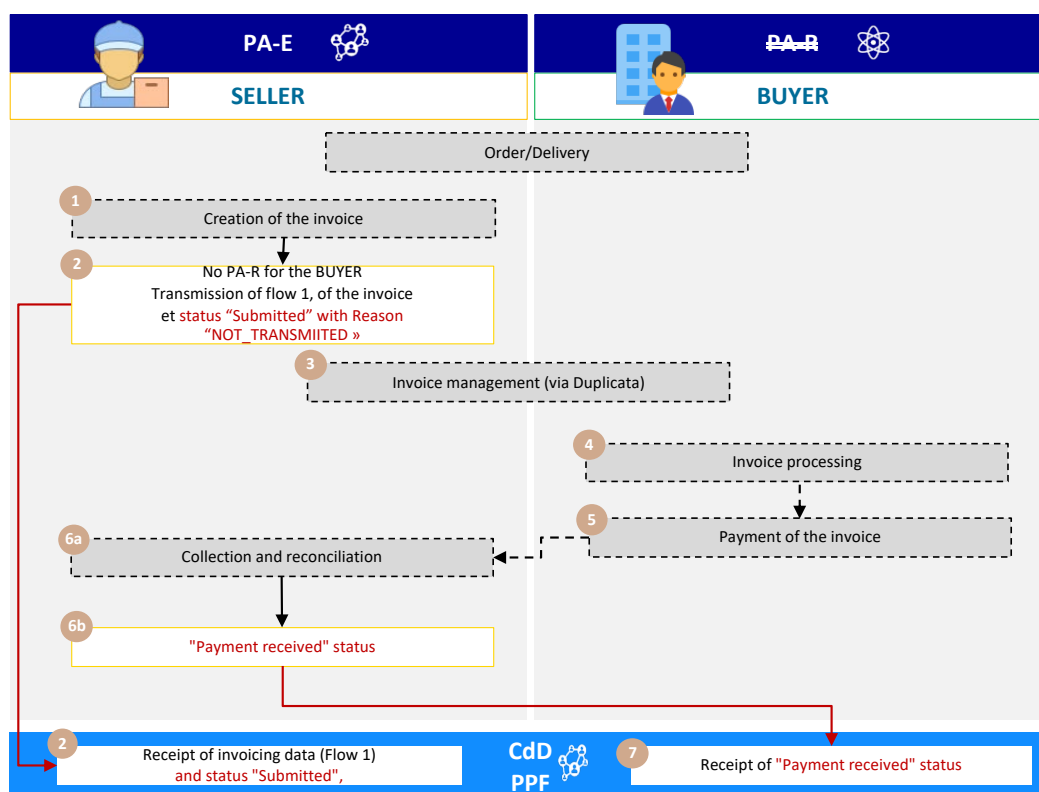


Figure 4: Invoice filed as "NOT_TRANSMITTED" due to lack of PA-R.

Obligations of the PA-E in the absence of an active BUYER address:

- If the invoice is deemed compliant, set the status to "Submitted" with the reason "NOT_TRANSMITTED," transmit it to the PPF Data Concentrator, and make it available to the SELLER. Transmit flow 1.

Optional PA-E features in the absence of an active BUYER address:

- The PA-E may offer to resend the invoice for several days, then, at the request of its customer, the SELLER, to resume the normal invoice life cycle, this option remaining available for a reasonable period (a few months, for example).

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SELLER obligations if the BUYER does not have an active address:

- **The SELLER MUST still issue the invoice via its e-invoicing platform. It may then (or beforehand) contact its customer to ensure that the latter is equipped to receive it. It MAY offer to send its customer a duplicate of the invoice (e.g., a LEGIBLE version of the invoice).**
- **The SELLER MUST file a Paid life cycle status after payment has been received, if VAT is due upon payment receipt.**

4.5 Rejection upon receipt

When an invoice is received by a PA-R, the latter must carry out the regulatory checks. In the event of an error, the PA-R MUST reject the invoice. It creates the status "Rejected" (code 213), for which a reason must be given to explain the reason for the REJECTION. This status MUST be transmitted to the PPF Data Concentrator. It MUST be transmitted to the issuer of the invoice (the SELLER) through its PA-E. It MUST be made available to the BUYER for information purposes.

Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
1	Creation of the invoice for the BUYER	SELLER	Following a commercial transaction (order/delivery, service contract, spot purchase, etc.), the SELLER creates the invoice (flow 2) via its information system. It can entrust the creation of the invoice to an OD/SC (Compatible Solution) or to its PA-E. It sends it to its PA-E for processing.
2	Transmission of flow 1, the invoice (flow 2), and related statuses	PA-E	Once the PA-E has carried out the regulatory compliance checks, including checks for duplicates and the existence of an active electronic invoicing address, it MUST transmit the data required by the Administration (flow 1) to the PPF Data Concentrator (CdD PPF). It MUST transmit the invoice (stream 2 or stream 3) to the BUYER's PA-R. It must transmit the "Submitted" status to the CdD PPF.
3a 3b	Rejection of the invoice upon receipt	PA-R	The BUYER's platform (PA-R) receives the invoice (flow 2 or flow 3), performs the regulatory checks, and finds an error. It must create a "Rejected" status (code 213) with the reason for rejection and send it to the CdD PPF and the PA-E for the attention of the SELLER. It makes the status available to the BUYER but does not deliver the invoice to them unless requested to do so.
1b	The SELLER cancels the rejected invoice in the accounts.	SELLER	The SELLER cancels the rejected invoice in its accounts, for example by creating an INTERNAL CREDIT NOTE (i.e., not sent to the recipient who did not receive the invoice rejected by its PA-R). It does not send it to its PA-E, except for archiving purposes only, if applicable. If the E-PA receives a CREDIT NOTE from the SELLER referring to a Rejected invoice, it MUST NOT send it to the BUYER, nor send a 1 flow to the CdD PPF.

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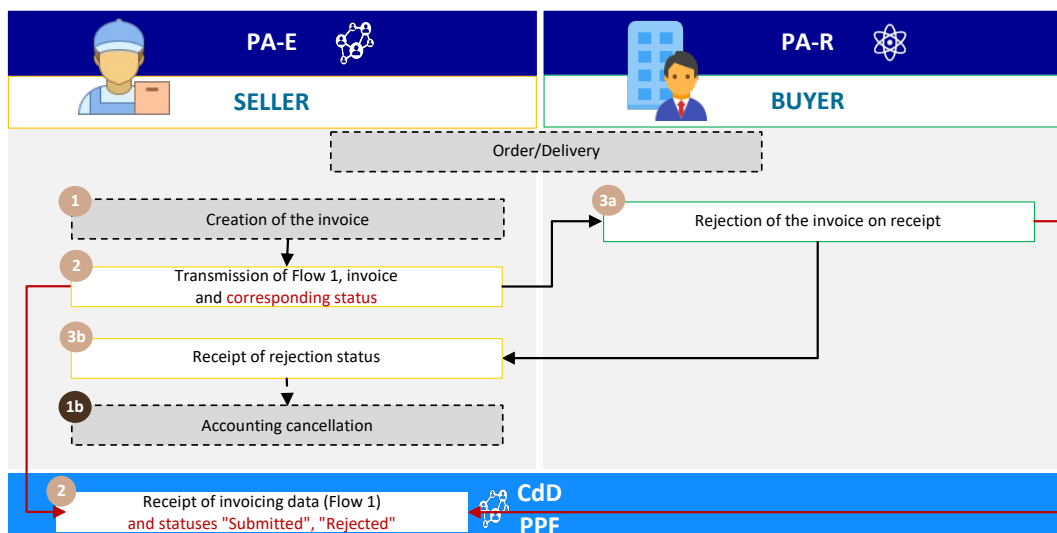


Figure5: Rejection of an invoice upon receipt

Obligations of the PA-R in the event of rejection upon receipt:

- **Set the status to "Rejected," with a reason for rejection from the list of applicable reasons, send it to the CdD PPF and the PA-E, and make it available to the BUYER.**

Obligations of the PA-E in the event of rejection upon receipt:

- **Make the status "Rejected" available to the SELLER.**

SELLER obligations in the event of rejection upon receipt:

- **Cancel the posting of an invoice that has been given a "Rejected" status by PA-R, for example by creating an INTERNAL CREDIT NOTE that is not sent to PA-E (except for archiving purposes only), based on the "Rejected" life cycle status (supporting accounting document).**

Optional PA-E features in the event of rejection upon receipt:

- **If the SELLER sends its PA-E a CREDIT NOTE referring to an initial Rejected invoice referenced in BG-3 (reference to a previous invoice), the PA-E does not send the CREDIT NOTE to the BUYER and does not send a flow 1 of this credit note to the CdD PPF.**

4.6 Refusal of an invoice by the BUYER (the recipient)

The BUYER may reject the invoice. As a result, the flow 1 sent in parallel with the issuance of the invoice to its recipient is ignored by the tax authorities for VAT pre-filling. In theory, this requires the SELLER to cancel the "Rejected" invoice in its accounts, for example by creating an INTERNAL CREDIT NOTE that is not sent to the BUYER and without a flow 1 sent to the CdD PPF, and by creating a new invoice if necessary. On the BUYER's side, setting a "Refused" status leads either to the invoice not being recorded or to its cancellation, justified by the "Refused" status (to be kept as an accounting document). Consequently, the "Rejected" status **MUST NOT** be used in the event of a dispute or disagreement over the content of an invoice, and **MUST ALWAYS** be accompanied by a reason for "Refusal" from the list of applicable reasons for Refusal, which correspond to:

- Either a regulatory non-compliance not tested by the PA-R (e.g., absence of a Purchase Order number provided prior to invoicing).
- Either a bill for an unknown transaction, i.e., for which the BUYER does not know the SELLER or has not purchased anything from them that would justify receiving a bill.

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- Or, where applicable, a breach of contractual conditions preventing the recipient from processing the invoice, which must be limited to the provision of additional references from among those available in the semantic model of essential invoice data EN16931 and known to the SELLER at the time of invoicing.

The list of reasons for "Refusal" is described in Annex A of Standard XP Z12-012. To take in account current system, a list of B2G Refusal reasons has been added; it can only be used for B2G invoices processed by CHORUS PRO.

For the CdD PPF, any "Refused" status assigned to an invoice cannot be followed by another status for that invoice. Therefore, once a "Rejected" or "Refused" status has been assigned, no other "mandatory" status can be assigned by the Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées») or end users on behalf of the SELLER or BUYER (as a reminder, the "Mandatory" statuses are: "Submitted," "Rejected," "Refused," and "Payment Received").

A "Refused" status results in the VAT prefilled on the underlying invoice being reversed, provided that the status is assigned during the invoice's VAT pre-fill period. However, if the "Refused" status is assigned after the VAT pre-filling period (for example, a status assigned in May for an invoice issued in March which appears on the end-of-April VAT return), it has no impact on the subsequent VAT pre-filling. **This reinforces the best practice of issuing "Refused" statuses within a few days of receiving the invoice and switching to the "Dispute" status after that period.**

Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
1	Creation of the invoice for the BUYER	SELLER	Following a commercial transaction (order/delivery, service contract, spot purchase, etc.), the SELLER creates the invoice (flow 2) via its information system. It may entrust the creation of the invoice to an OD/SC (Compatible Solution) or to its PA-E. It sends it to its PA-E for processing.
2	Transmission of flow 1, the invoice (flow 2), and related statuses	PA-E	Once the PA-E has carried out the regulatory compliance checks, including checks for duplicates and the existence of an active electronic invoicing address, it MUST send the data required by the Administration (flow 1) to the PPF Data Concentrator (CdD PPF). It MUST transmit the invoice (stream 2 or stream 3) to the BUYER's PA-R. It must transmit the "Submitted" status to the PPF Data Concentrator.
3	Receipt of the invoice	PA-R	The BUYER's platform (PA-R) receives the invoice (flow 2 or flow 3), performs the regulatory checks, creates the transmission statuses (here "Received," then "Made Available") and makes the invoice available to the BUYER for processing.
4a 4b	Rejection of the invoice	BUYER PA-R	The BUYER processes the invoice and decides to reject it by selecting the reason for rejection from a strict list (see standard XP Z12-012). The PA-R transmits the status "Rejected," along with the reason, to the CdD PPF and the PA-E, for the attention of the SELLER.
4c	Receipt of "Refused" status	SELLER PA-E	The PA-E receives the "Refusal" status. It makes it available to the SELLER.
1a	The SELLER cancels the "Refused" invoice in the accounts.	SELLER	The SELLER cancels the "Refused" invoice in its accounts, for example by creating an INTERNAL CREDIT NOTE. It does not send it to its PA-E, except for archiving purposes only, if applicable. If the PA-E receives a CREDIT NOTE referring to a "Rejected" invoice from the SELLER, it must not send it to the BUYER, nor send a flow 1 to the CdD PPF.
1b	If necessary, the BUYER cancels the registration of the invoice it has refused.	BUYER	If the BUYER has already recorded the invoice in its accounts prior to its rejection, it must cancel it, as the "Refused" status constitutes the supporting accounting document.

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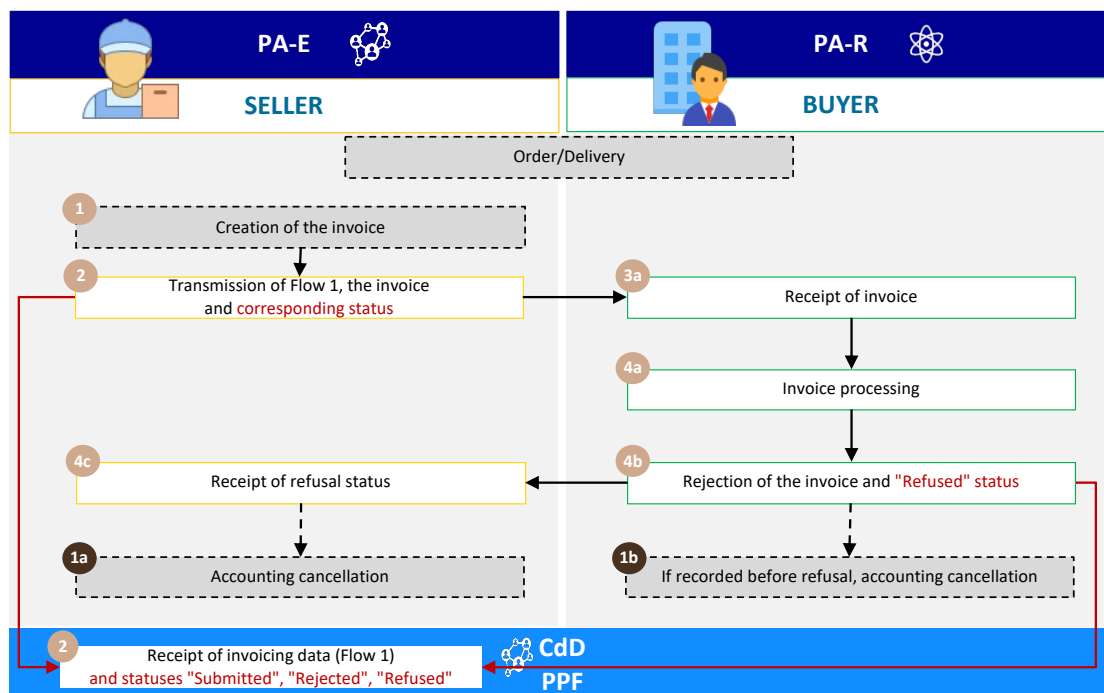


Figure6: Rejection of an invoice by the BUYER (recipient of the invoice)

NOTE: in the event of misuse of the "Rejected" status, or if this status is applied in error, the SELLER may decide to maintain its invoice and not cancel it in its accounts. They shall inform the BUYER of this outside of the life cycle exchanges. This may therefore lead to a dispute between the SELLER and the BUYER, or an agreement to maintain the invoice and not have to cancel it in the accounts on either side and to reissue an identical new invoice with a different issue date and potentially an impact on payment terms. However, the consequence remains that the pre-filled VAT will not take into account this retention and therefore the VAT on this "Rejected" invoice, both for the VAT collected on the SELLER's side and for the deductible VAT on the BUYER's side. This issue is likely to be clarified in a future version.

PA-R obligations in the event of refusal by the BUYER:

- **Transmit the "Rejected" status to the CdD PPF and the PA-E.**

Obligations of the PA-E in the event of refusal by the BUYER:

- **Provide the SELLER with the status "Refused" (with the reason).**

Optional PA-E features in the event of rejection by the BUYER:

- **If the SELLER sends its PA-E a CREDIT NOTE referring to an initial Rejected invoice referenced in BG-3 (reference to a previous invoice), the PA-E does not send the CREDIT NOTE to the BUYER and does not send flow 1 to the CdD PPF.**

Actions taken by the SELLER in the event of refusal by the BUYER:

- **Based on the "Rejected" life cycle status, the SELLER cancels the posting of the invoice on which the "Rejected" status has been placed by the BUYER, for example by creating an INTERNAL CREDIT NOTE that is not sent to the PA-E (except for archiving purposes only). This ensures that the VAT return will be aligned with the VAT pre-fill proposed by the tax authorities.**
- **However, the SELLER may contest the REFUSAL. In this case, they will initiate a dispute with the BUYER and will not create a CREDIT NOTE. This must be done outside of the life cycle status exchange. A future version of this Document will examine whether it is necessary to provide for a life cycle status exchange dedicated to this normally rare case. In this case, the SELLER's**

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VAT return will retain the VAT on this invoice. If the BUYER finally accepts the invoice, then the SELLER and the BUYER will have a discrepancy between their VAT return and the pre-filled VAT return, equal to the VAT on the invoice, since the tax authorities will have canceled the VAT on the rejected invoice.

Actions taken by the BUYER in the event of refusal by the BUYER:

- **Based on the "Rejected" life cycle status, the BUYER does not record the "Rejected" invoice or cancels its recording. The "Rejected" status serves as supporting documentation for, for example, posting a "Miscellaneous Transaction" entry to cancel a "Rejected" invoice. No CREDIT NOTE is therefore expected by the BUYER.**
- **However, the BUYER may contest the "Rejected" status. They may then finally accept the invoice and record it, then process it, which is currently organized outside of life cycle status exchanges. On the other hand, the BUYER's and SELLER's pre-filled VAT will show a discrepancy with the VAT return equal to the VAT on this "Rejected" invoice.**

4.7 Management of a "Dispute" followed by a CREDIT NOTE

This case mainly describes how to manage a CREDIT NOTE that partially or totally cancels a disputed invoice.

Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
1	Creation of invoice F1 for the BUYER	SELLER	Following a commercial transaction (order/delivery, service contract, spot purchase, etc.), the SELLER creates the invoice (flow 2) via its information system. It may entrust the creation of the invoice to an OD/SC (Compatible Solution) or to its PA-E. It sends it to its PA-E for processing.
2	Transmission of flow 1, the invoice (flow 2), and related statuses	PA-E	Once the PA-E has carried out the regulatory compliance checks, including checks for duplicates and the existence of an active electronic invoicing address, it MUST send the data required by the Administration (flow 1) to the PPF Data Concentrator (CdD PPF). It MUST transmit the invoice (stream 2 or stream 3) to the BUYER's PA-R. It must transmit the "Submitted" status to the PPF Data Concentrator.
3	Receipt of the invoice	PA-R	The BUYER's platform (PA-R) receives the F1 invoice, performs the regulatory checks, creates the transmission statuses (here "Received," then "Made Available") and makes the invoice available to the BUYER for processing.
4a 4b	Processing of the invoice and updating of statuses prior to payment	BUYER PA-R	The BUYER processes the invoice and notices a discrepancy with what is expected. They therefore set the status to "In Dispute," with a mandatory reason and, if applicable, an expected action (e.g., request for a CREDIT NOTE), to be sent to the SELLER via the PA-R and PA-E.
4c	Receipt of invoice statuses	SELLER	The SELLER receives the "In dispute" status of the invoice.

Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
1 (F2)	Creation of a CREDIT	SELLER	The SELLER creates a CREDIT NOTE, either total or partial.
2	Transmission of the CREDIT NOTE	PA-E	The PA-E processes the CREDIT F2, transmits flow 1 and the "Submitted" status of F2 to the CdD PPF, and the CREDIT F2 to the PA-R.

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3	Receipt of CREDIT	PA-R	The PA-R receives the F2 CREDIT, processes it, and makes it available to the BUYER.
4a 4b	Processing of the F2 CREDIT NOTE and the F1 INVOICE	BUYER	The BUYER approves the F1 Invoice that was in "Dispute" and the F2 CREDIT NOTE by setting the status to "Approved" on each document, potentially in a Life cycle status message common to F1 and F2.
4c	Receipt of F2 statuses	SELLER	The SELLER receives the "Approved" statuses for F1 and F2.
5a 5b	In the event of a partial CREDIT, payment and "Payment Sent" status.	BUYER	In the event of a partial credit, the BUYER pays the balance F1 – F2 and sends the status "Payment Sent" on F1 for the amount of the balance, or on F1 as positive and on F2 as negative.
5c	Receipt of payment statuses	SELLER	The seller receives the payment statuses from F1, or even F2.
6a 6b	Reconciliation of receipt (if partial credit note)	SELLER /PA-E	Reconciliation of cash receipts. If VAT is charged on receipt: • (Highly Recommended) create a "Received" status for F1 (total) and for F2 (negative amount), which allows the "Received" status to be considered final in this case (F1 and F2 definitively processed). • Or create a partial "Received" status on F1 (if partial payment), and nothing else. In this case, everyone must understand that F1 and F2 are definitively processed. Transmission of the "Received" status to PA-R and CdD PPF.
6c	Receipt of "Paid" statuses	BUYER	The BUYER receives the "Paid" statuses.
7	Receipt of "Paid" status by CdD PPF	CdD PPF	Receipt of "Paid" status by CdD PPF.

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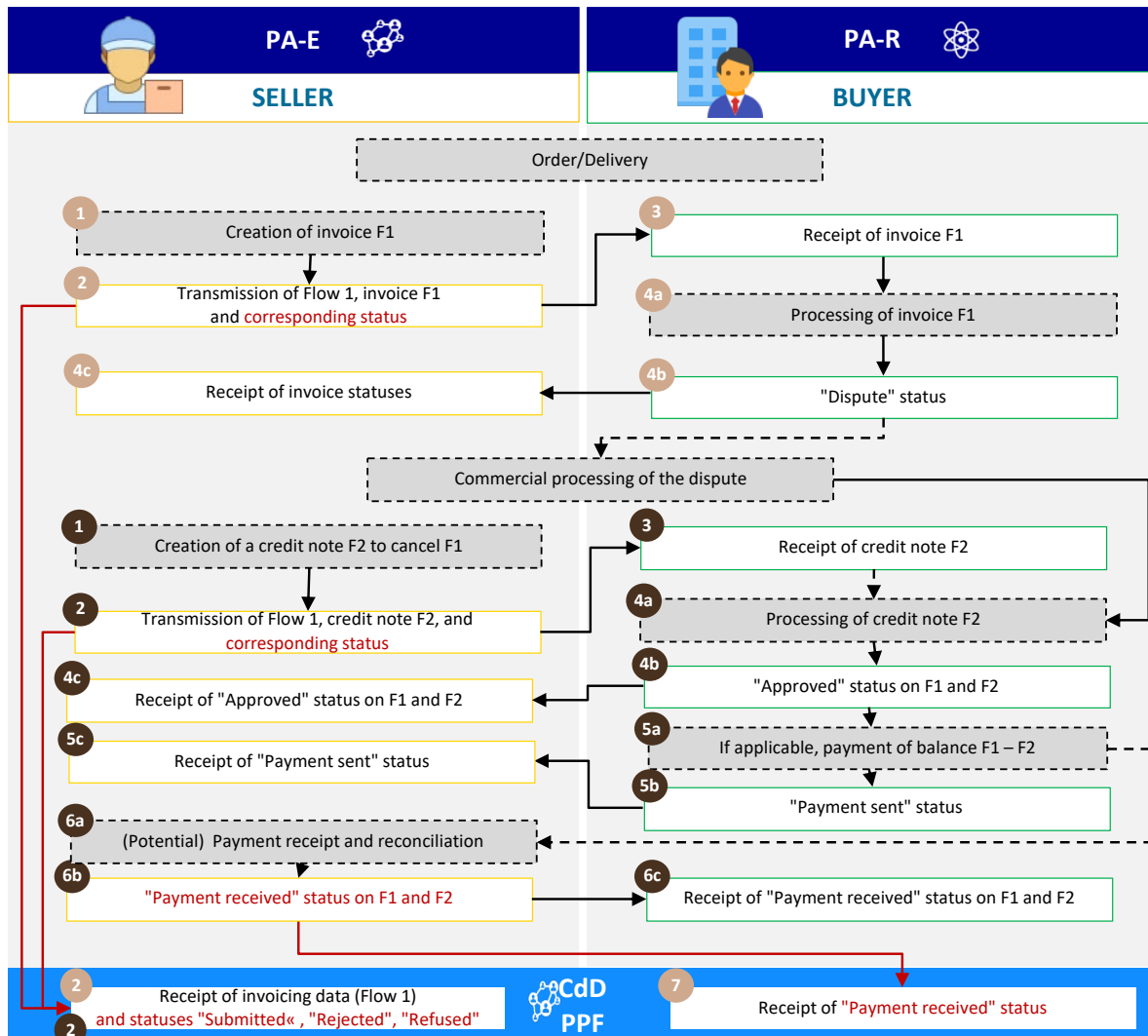


Figure7: Invoice in dispute, followed by a partial or total CREDIT NOTE

PA-R obligations in the event of "Disputed" status followed by a partial or total CREDIT NOTE:

- Transmit the "In Dispute" status from F1 to the PA-E, then process the F2 CREDIT NOTE as a normal invoice, with its statuses set by the BUYER.

Obligations of the PA-E in the event of "Disputed" status followed by a partial or total CREDIT NOTE:

- Provide the SELLER with the "In Dispute" status of F1, with its reason and required action, then process the CREDIT NOTE F2 as a normal invoice, including for the exchange of statuses set by the BUYER or the SELLER.

SELLER obligations in the event of "Disputed" status followed by a partial or total CREDIT NOTE:

- If the SELLER accepts the resolution of the dispute, they create a CREDIT NOTE F2 and then treat it as an invoice.

Obligations of the BUYER in the event of a "Disputed" status followed by a partial or total CREDIT NOTE:

- If they receive an F2 CREDIT NOTE, they treat it as an invoice. A good practice is to approve the F1 invoice and the CREDIT NOTE, then pay the balance as the result of the payment of the F1 invoice from which the amount of the F2 CREDIT NOTE is deducted.

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4.8 Management of a "Dispute" followed by a Corrected Invoice

This case mainly describes how to manage a corrected invoice created to cancel and replace a disputed invoice.

Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
1	Creation of invoice F1 for the BUYER	SELLER	Following a commercial transaction (order/delivery, service contract, spot purchase, etc.), the SELLER creates the invoice (flow 2) via its information system. It can entrust the creation of the invoice to an OD/SC (Compatible Solution) or to its PA-E. It sends it to its PA-E for processing.
2	Transmission of flow 1, the invoice (flow 2), and related statuses	PA-E	Once the PA-E has carried out the regulatory compliance checks, including checks for duplicates and the existence of an active electronic invoicing address, it MUST transmit the data required by the Administration (flow 1) to the Cdd PPF. It MUST transmit the invoice (flow 2 or flow 3) to the BUYER's PA-R. It must send the "Submitted" status to the Cdd PPF.
3	Receipt of the invoice	PA-R	The BUYER's platform (PA-R) receives the F1 invoice, performs the regulatory checks, creates the transmission statuses (here "Received," then "Made Available") and makes the invoice available to the BUYER for processing.
4a 4b	Processing of the invoice and updating of statuses prior to payment	BUYER PA-R	The BUYER processes the invoice and notices a discrepancy with what is expected. They therefore assign a "Disputed" status, with a mandatory reason and, if applicable, an expected action (e.g., request for a corrected invoice), to be sent to the SELLER via PA-R and PA-E.
4c	Receipt of invoice statuses	SELLER	The SELLER receives the "In dispute" status of the invoice and the request for a Corrected Invoice.

Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
1 (F2)	Creation of a Corrected Invoice F2	SELLER	The SELLER creates a Corrected Invoice. It must reference the invoice it is canceling and replacing in BG-3 (previous invoice). From an accounting perspective, this means that the referenced invoice must be canceled and replaced by the Corrected Invoice.
2	Transmission of the F2 Corrected Invoice	PA-E	The PA-E processes the F2 invoice, transmits flow 1 and the "Submitted" status of F2 to the Cdd PPF, and the Corrected Invoice F2 to the PA-R.
3	Receipt of the F2 Corrected Invoice	PA-R	The PA-R receives the F2 Corrected Invoice, processes it, and makes it available to the BUYER.
4a 4b	Processing of the F2 Corrected Invoice	BUYER	The BUYER processes the F2 Corrected Invoice, which begins with the cancellation of F1 (justified by the existence of F2), followed by the processing of F2 as a new invoice. To ensure that Invoice F1 does not remain indefinitely with the status "In Dispute," it may be useful to assign it the status "Canceled" and send it to the SELLER.
4c	Receipt of F2 statuses, or even "Canceled" status for F1	SELLER	The SELLER receives the status of F2 (presumably "Approved") and potentially the "Canceled" status of F1.
5a 5b	Payment of F2 invoice Creation and transmission of the "Payment transmitted" status.	BUYER / PA-R	The BUYER pays the F2 invoice to the SELLER. They can send a "Payment Sent" status to the SELLER via the PA-R (recommended).

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Step	Step name	Responsible party	Description
5c	Receipt of "Payment Transmitted" status	SELLER / PA-E	The SELLER receives the "Payment Transmitted" status for F2 from their PA-E.
6a 6b	Invoice payment receipt	SELLER	The SELLER receives payment for invoice F2 (outside the circuit).
6c	Issuance of "Payment Received" status	SELLER / PA-E	If the VAT on the F2 invoice is payable upon payment receipt, the SELLER creates the "Payment Received" status and transmits it to the CdD PPF via its PA-E. The PA-E also transmits the "Payment Received" status to the PA-R for the attention of the BUYER.
7	Receipt of "Paid" status by the BUYER	BUYER PA-R	The BUYER receives the "Received" status from F2.

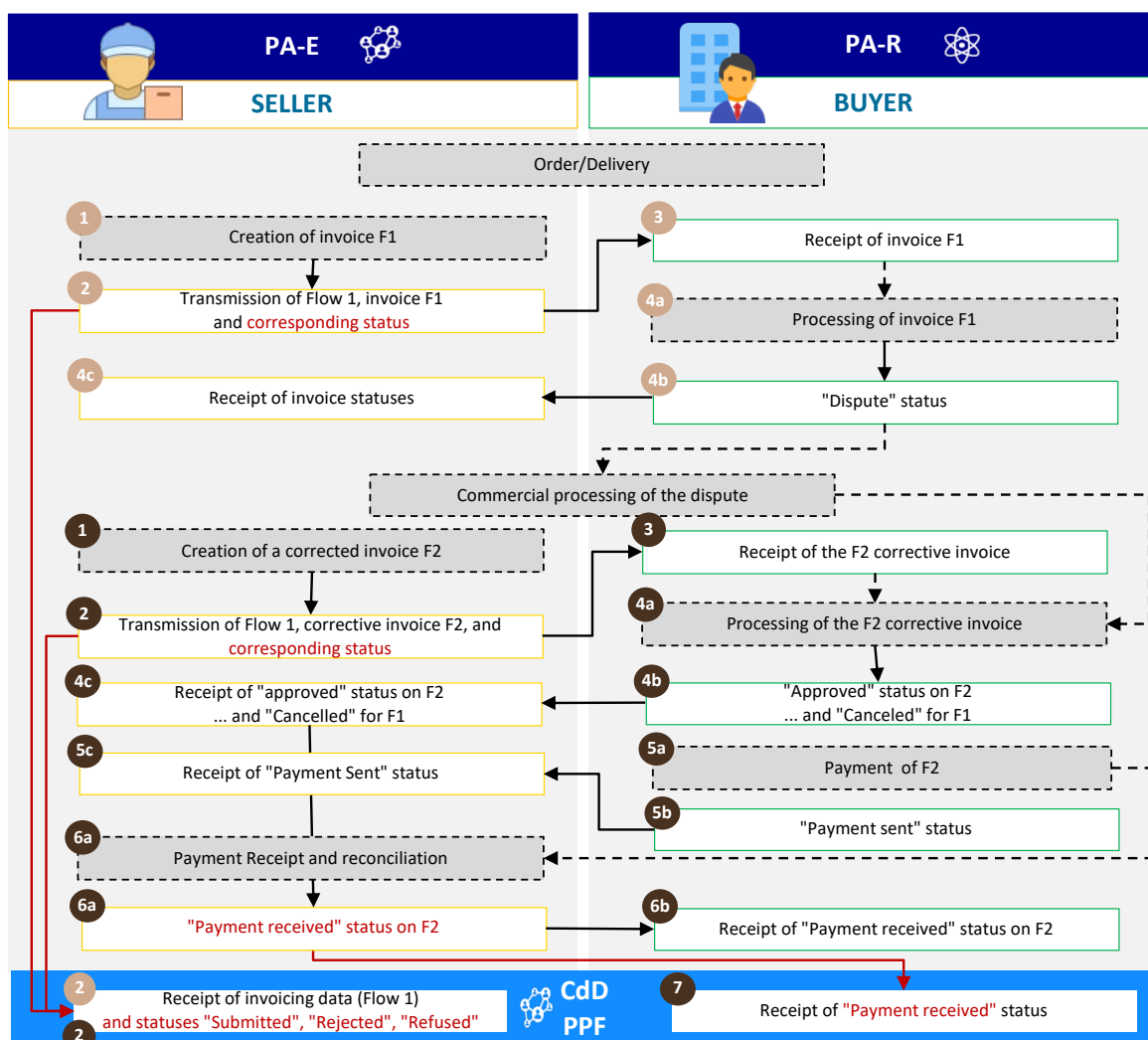


Figure8: Invoice in dispute, followed by a Corrected Invoice

PA-R obligations in the event of "Disputed" status followed by a Corrected Invoice:

- **Transmit the "In Dispute" status of invoice F1 to the PA-E, then process the Corrected Invoice F2 as a normal invoice, with its statuses set by the BUYER.**

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Obligations of the PA-E in the event of "Disputed" status followed by a Corrected Invoice:

- **Provide the SELLER with the "In Dispute" status of invoice F1, with its reason and required action, then process the Corrected Invoice F2 as a normal invoice, including for the exchange of statuses set by the BUYER or SELLER.**

SELLER's obligations in the event of "Disputed" status followed by a Corrected Invoice:

- **If the SELLER accepts the resolution of the dispute by means of a Corrected Invoice, they shall create a Corrected Invoice F2, which cancels invoice F1 (cancellation entry to be organized), and then treat invoice F2 as an invoice. They can set the status of Invoice F1 to "Cancelled" to signify the end of the lifecycle and share this with the SELLER via their respective PAs.**

Obligations of the BUYER in the event of "Disputed" status followed by a Corrected Invoice:

- **If the BUYER receives a Corrected Invoice F2, they MUST cancel the posting of Invoice F1 in their accounts, then treat Invoice F2 as a standard invoice. To avoid leaving Invoice F1 in "Disputed" status indefinitely, they can set it to "Cancelled" status and share this with the SELLER via their respective Accredited Platforms («Plateformes Agréées»).**

4.9 Specific use cases

Specific use cases involve several types of issues, some of which may be combined:

- How to use the EN16931 standard and, where applicable, the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile to provide all the information present and required in certain invoices, for example:
 - ✓ Energy bills contain operational information such as phone numbers, but also consumption indexes, taxes, information on CO2 emissions, etc.
 - ✓ Transport invoices shall indicate where a delivery comes from and where it is going, weights, volumes, additional services (extra fuel, weekend delivery, etc.).
 - ✓ Some invoices contain composite products sold as a package but consisting of sub-items with different VAT rates, such as a toy book.
 - ✓ Some invoices have negative lines, for example for revised consumption estimates.
 - ✓ Pre-payment invoices and, above all, final invoices must indicate that part of the VAT has already been included in the advance invoice.
 - ✓ Some invoices have different reasons for VAT exemption from one line to another.
 - ✓ Some invoices shall group lines and show subtotals.
 - ✓ ...
- How to manage invoices that have already been paid, or part of which is or will be paid by a third party at the initiative of the SELLER (e.g., insurance covering part of the invoice, a government subsidy), or by a third party listed as the BUYER (cash pooling, card issuer, etc.): This has a direct impact on the management of the "Payment Received" status and on when it shall be issued.
- How to manage invoices that are in practice created and issued by a third-party invoicer, for example a transparent intermediary acting as the SELLER's agent. How are the transmission, checks (including the existence of the necessary invoicing mandate), life cycle status returns, transmission of invoices to the SELLER, and access to life cycle statuses are organized?
- Sometimes, a transparent intermediary may act as an opaque intermediary, for example by consolidating a customer's purchases from several sellers, such as travel agencies, taxi booking companies, highway toll subscription companies, or fuel card providers. Some sellers also integrate third-party services, but as transparent intermediaries, such as water distribution companies (with sanitation services), leasing services (with third-party insurance and maintenance), etc. All of this

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results in multi-seller invoices, for which solutions should be found that do not disrupt current operational practices.

- How to manage invoices that are processed by a third party authorized by the BUYER, for example as a transparent intermediary acting as the BUYER, using the BUYER's ability to dedicate electronic addresses for invoice reception for certain uses and entrust their management to third parties.
- How to manage the expenses of employees who pay directly (which leads to invoices that have already been paid) and shall be reimbursed for invoices exchanged directly between the SELLER and the BUYER.
- ...

These use cases were instructed in accordance with the following two principles, as far as possible:

- **"Same problems, same solutions"**: the issues raised by companies through use cases are sometimes very similar from one sector to another.
- **"Do not export complexity to counterparties"**: there are sector-specific characteristics, but it is important not to resolve them by imposing specific constraints on the outside world, or as little as possible.

The use cases dealt with can lead to two types of resolution:

- Indicate which data from the EN16931 model can be used to code certain invoices and, if necessary, refer to the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile for additional data.
- Indicate how third parties can interact with the management process.

For the second type, several third parties are provided for in the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile. However, these third parties generally act either on behalf of the SELLER or on behalf of the BUYER. It is therefore primarily up to the PA-E and PA-R to propose solutions to enable these third parties to access invoices and life cycle statuses in order to act on behalf of the SELLER or the BUYER.

This rights management can be facilitated by displaying the Third Parties named in the invoices. For this reason, different roles have been provided in the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile:

- The PAYER third party (EXT-FR-FE-BG-02)
- The BUYER's AGENT third party (EXT-US-FE-BG-01)
- The SELLER's AGENT third party (EXT-US-FE-BG-03)
- The INVOICER third party (EXT-US-FE-BG-05)
- The "ADDRESSEE" or "INVOICEE" third party (EXT-US-FE-BG-04)

The presence of these third parties on invoices can help organize access rights or actions on invoices. However, these rights can also be organized independently by the Accredited Platform ("Plateforme Aréée"), which may wish to associate them with a management process. This avoids imposing the use of the EXTENDED-CTC-FR profile on the SELLER, but above all ensures that SELLERS do not have to manage a repository of third parties acting on behalf of the BUYER to be included in their invoices, particularly when these third parties are not directly involved by the SELLER, but only intervene due to the specific characteristics of the BUYER.

The instructions for these specific cases are detailed in Annex A of this document.

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**Annexe A
(normative)**

Description of the main specific use cases

XP_Z12-014_CAS_USAGE_Annexe_A_V1.4_EN.pdf

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Annexe B (normative)

Examples of invoices (flow 2) and CDAR lifecycle messages for the nominal use case

XP_Z12-014_CAS_USAGE_Annexe_B_V1.4_EN.pdf

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